

K T M O R R I S O N

CONFESS
your SINS *to*
HANNAH



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Confess Your Sins To Hannah

KT Morrison

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About the Author

KT Morrison writes stories about women who fall in love with sexy men who aren't their husband, and loving relationships that go too far—couples who open a mysterious door, then struggle to get it closed as trouble pushes through the threshold.

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CONFESS YOUR SINS TO HANNAH

35,000 words

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Prologue

I'd like to think that I need no introduction, but my vainer days are behind me. I am Hannah Monroe, that young upstart founder of the blog wickedsexbook, and award-winning writer for Teen Vixen magazine. You may know me for some of my more widely shared and gregarious articles such as "When is it too long?" or "Hey, ladies, how do we feel about VPL's?" I'm pretty outspoken. (For the uninitiated, VPL's are visible penis lines). In that article, which I wrote for Teen Vixen, I surmised, given the current revealing trends in women's fashion, that men's should also follow suit. Why shouldn't we girls also be privy to what attributes a man might be able to present to us? I surmised a time where the fashion of tight pantaloons returned. Harkening back to the painting of Jean-Baptiste Belley, and the incredible bulge down one of his pant legs. Why shouldn't we girls also know what a man had to offer? Why was it only us wearing tube tops and yoga pants? I tempered with this argument: Were VPL's just good personal marketing or should we worry they were tools of the patriarchy?

Not exactly my most serious article, but then again, I was nineteen and just getting used to my newfound fame. I was in the first year at college when my homemade blog journaling my adventures as a young woman on campus seeking her sexual identity blew up. The blog went crazy. I wrote a book. I published a picture book with Sparrow House. I went on Jimmy Fallon. Teen Vixen hired me. I was going into my third year at Brown, and I was making six figures a year writing sexy junk for young girls. I did sex toy reviews. Pornographic film reviews. Talked about male porn stars in a mainstream straightforwardness. But my mainstay was always my favorite topic: the penis.

I wasn't ashamed to talk about penises. Wasn't ashamed to say how much I enjoyed them. Was curious about them. I divulged what other girls would sensibly keep secret. How I used to fantasize about them. How I would

draw pictures of them. How I would peep on unsuspecting boys if I knew they might be changing. And then, more blatantly, when I was older, just straight up asking: “Hey, stud, why don’t you whip it out?” I always thought that was a pretty direct question. It got the result quick. If the guy had something I liked, he would show it to me. If he didn’t, he’d slink away. It was like weeding the garden.

But as time goes by, things often change. Not unsurprising. Slowly, the marketplace morphed. My fanbase grew up, as did I. And Teen Vixen went in a more serious route, looking for journalists writing things that mattered. Like penises don’t matter. I stayed on at TV doing Op Ed, but my weekly column went monthly. Then I resigned. The blog closed up. I was ending my fourth year and looking toward a different future myself. I’d said just about everything I thought to say about men as sexual beings. Turning the male gaze on its ear, looking out through a horny woman’s eyes. What turns a gal on?—click to find out.

But the inspiring feelings, those hormonal urges I had as a young burgeoning woman, didn’t go away. My brain matured. I took the concept more seriously. I did a graduate program. Master’s in psychology. And it was there that I lingered on my topic, becoming quite serious about it. Yes, still talking about penises. What was it that was so alluring? Was it biological? It seemed evolutionary, didn’t it? And then, also, it didn’t. What was so alluring about a man with a large penis? Was he more likely to impregnate me? Was that my human female animal brain talking? Guys with little dicks were getting girls pregnant everywhere. So it wouldn’t be that. Was it the pleasure? I definitely did like the pleasure a large penis brought. But . . . there were some guys with some regular size ones who lit me up pretty good. Was it a symbol of masculinity? A man with a big penis inspired recognition of male dominance, made us want to be more submissive and taken care of. A man with a big penis was a man who could provide. But weren’t men with smaller penises providing every day? What was it in us that made us want them?

Now, look, I know: not all of us. Some of us. That’s what my thesis stated. I won’t divulge my paper, because it’ll blow this book I’m trying to write. Maybe it’s a book, maybe it’s a bunch of articles. Maybe it’s nothing. I

don't know. For now, it's conjecture and research. I interviewed many women for my thesis and was thrilled to find that I wasn't alone in my lust for a certain kind of penis. I already knew that, given the comments on my blog and on my TV articles. But what I hadn't expected was that as a master's student, and in an educational atmosphere, the women I talked to were forthcoming and candid, and most importantly: offered a level of sincerity to which I was unaccustomed. And it opened my eyes. Opened my eyes, but I still didn't see. I wanted to know more. So I started my new blog. This one with less campy repartee, no pictures of my teen crush celebrities with their crotches circled. No sports athletes with accidental bulge revelations. This was time for serious talk. Some of my old fan base returned. They were older now, too, and in a different place. Young girls still came, though not in the droves they use to. Times do change.

But what I asked for, I got.

If you've ever risked it all, cheated, almost got fired, did something death-defying, all for the sake of a sexual encounter with a man who had a large penis I want to talk to you.

If you check my site, you'll see that I worded it far more carefully and with much more dignity—but you get the gist.

Over the last year, I've emailed and corresponded with women of all ages willing to tell me about that one time with that one guy. You know the one. I think we all have one. I met with some of these women. I met with some of them, and they were amazing women who inspired me, broke my heart, made me angry, made me laugh. We're all different, but we're all the same. I still don't know what I'm going to do with all these stories, but for now I'm collecting them here. I hope you enjoy them.

Jacqueline and the Cowboys

Part 1

Intro

The woman I'm calling Jacqueline wasn't what I'd expected. I met her at an IHOP in Billings, Montana—noticeably near the scene of the crime.

It's the morning, and it's cold. There's a thin sheet of snow over Billings, and it collects in a scrim outside the windows of the pancake house where I'm sitting waiting for an early morning breakfast. I've got coffee on the go, and I ordered pancakes and fried eggs for us both. When I talked to Jacqueline last night, I'd asked her what she'd like for breakfast. She'd pressed on me how little time she'd have to meet with me—if she could make it at all. So, I'm prepared. And hoping Jacqueline will show up so I don't have to eat both our breakfasts. It's too long a trip home to New York for a doggie bag to survive, though Mister Earl would have loved them desperately.

Though it's Montana, I really could be anywhere in the suburban U.S. There might be a lot more pickup trucks here, but my view is the same as almost any small city. Past the IHOP's parking lot, there's a main thoroughfare. Across the thoroughfare there's an Arby's with a busy drive through (and I wonder what Arby's serves for breakfast that's so popular). There's a Cafe Rio, an Office Depot . . . behind me somewhere is the Walmart Supercenter that the IHOP shares real estate with. It's funny to me, because Jacqueline's story excited me. Not because of its terribleness (though that was exciting), but because of its certain Romantic authenticity. Imagine: a real live cowboy . . . When she agreed to meet with me and I learned she'd stayed in Montana, I was ecstatic. Pictured meeting this roguish woman in some beer-stinking honky tonk. But Jacqueline wanted pancakes.

I see her then. Or who I imagine is her. A lone woman jogging the sidewalk headed toward the pancake house, all the sensible sedans nosed up neatly outside the Hertz rental. She's slim, athletic looking; her luscious chestnut

ponytail bobs and swings. Dressed for the weather, she's got on a light fleecy vest over top of a long sleeve poly shirt. She wears leggings and can get away with it.

Jacqueline would be a woman a breath above thirty now, and her tale of salacious woe occurred when she was but a pup of twenty-four. The woman I'm supposing is her trots up from the sidewalk, crossing the thin patch of snow-covered lawn, running right by my own sensible sedan rental sitting one spot aside from the handicap parking. She beats her hands together, trying to get them warm. Her thin black gloves aren't doing the trick, or perhaps it's a nervous tic. She's about to meet with some writer she sent an email to and talk about maybe the worst thing she's ever done, all in the name of catching some weapons-grade dick. I can't wait to talk to her. I toss up a friendly wave from my booth and she nods, her features a little narrowed by tension.

When she gets to the table, I rise and offer up a friendly handshake and tell her how glad I am she could make it. I note she has perfect skin. A very healthy color to her high cheekbones. She has a long straight nose and a small but plump set of lips. She wears no makeup, and I wonder what she looks like when she does—I figure she would be stunning.

Jacqueline tells me she won't have long to talk, then grumbles at herself for why she even came to meet me as we take our seats.

I offer up: "Because you want to talk about it."

She takes my offering and accepts it. Her tightness fades. She admits: "I do."

"You hate it, but there's still excitement in the reliving of it."

"I'm not reliving it."

The waitress pours Jacqueline a coffee and tops mine up.

"There's life in words," I tell her. "And I loved your email."

“Of course you would.”

I’m not offended. I earned my stripes. I said, “I could hear what the story meant to you. I could feel every emotion, and I sympathize with how it could trouble you. My book or whatever it’s going to be isn’t just about big dicks. Big dicks and how funny it is that we like them. I’m not that same writer.”

“I know you’re not. I hope I didn’t insult you.” She’s sullen and takes a sip of her coffee.

“Not insulted at all,” I assured her.

“You’re not the same writer, I don’t know why it sounded like I attacked you.”

“You’re nervous. It’s one thing to send me an email, another to sit face-to-face when I’m here in your home turf.”

She said, “Thomas’s got the kids. He’s doing their breakfast while I run. I said I was going to meet with one of the moms for breakfast. I hate lying to him.”

I wriggled in place, saying, “Look at me, one of the moms.” It gets a small laugh.

“I read your blog back when this thing happened to me.” She’s looking away and playing at untangling her perfect, untangled ponytail. “I still read you. I like what you do now better. Of course, I’m more mature as well.”

“You think it was immaturity that allowed it to happen?”

She’s quick to shake her head no.

She says, “You read my email.”

“Many times.”

She chuckles at this. Breakfast arrives, and we pour maple syrup and put jam on toast for a moment. We make small talk. Mostly about me. She wants to know how it all works, writing for magazines and having a publisher. I tell her and allow it to sound somewhat glamorous, though it's not. She tells me how she's teaching at a school in town. High school. I'm not sure she likes it. What she does like is the local community theater. She and Thomas are both very involved.

When I figure she's more comfortable and her laughs come a little easier, I withdraw from my satchel (sitting passenger with me on the IHOP bench) the crisp printed out sheets of her email. Jacqueline knows what they are already. Her happy expression loosens, but she's still smirking.

"I guess you want to talk about it."

"You told me you don't have long."

She nods, still smirking, pushes a small bite of pancake past her pretty lips. I wait. She says, "Where do you want to start?"

I say, "Let's begin with what you wrote me . . ."

Part 2

Jacqueline's Story

When I cheated on Thomas, we'd only been married for two years though I'd known him for four. The act of infidelity that day was also the craziest and most unexpected thing I've ever done in my entire life. Truly shocking behavior, and to this day I still sometimes can't believe it happened. Like maybe I'd dreamt it or something. But the truth is there: I really did this.

Maybe it was an alignment of the stars or something because nothing like it had ever happened prior, and to this day an urge like what came over me that day has never occurred since.

Thomas and I were married at the tender age of twenty-two. Still in college, and having dated since our second year, we got hitched during the summer before we both started grad school. Our first married years were done on the cheap in a lousy apartment in Missoula, both of us at UM doing a Master's program in Anthropology. Another thing we did together, and how we really fell for each other, was our side gig in theater.

Both of us had been high school drama geeks, plus Anthro majors; we watched all the same movies . . . I mean, we were meant for each other. And there's not a thing wrong with Thomas either. I love him desperately. I still—to this day—can't believe I let this event happen.

We had research jobs the summer after we graduated, employed at the University, but we were also members of what was called "The Tribe." It was a group of us from UM who loved theater, and some locals who were around our age. We had an Improv group that performed at the school, and more than half of us were involved in the local scene, as small as it was. Thomas was in a production of a show called "The Parrot," where he played a supporting role, and I had just wrapped up two weeks in a contemporary comedy version of "A Midsummer's Night."

Early August however, we were both enlisted in a fun show and we were excited. It was just a two-day event, but it paid pretty well (believe me, we had plenty of use for the money back then), and the whole premise was a hoot. Outside Missoula, in a town called West Wolf, there was a rodeo event called the Wild Wolf Stampede. Competitors were coming from all over the west, guys who rode bull, tie-down ropers, steer wrestlers, barrel racers, the whole shebang you'd expect to see when you live out there. Cowboys. And it was one of the most entertaining parts about being out in Montana for school because neither Thomas nor I were from there, we were from other states, me up north in Minnesota, and Thomas from North Carolina. Even after being in the state for six years at the time, we could still get wowed by some of the area's more authentic Western elements. This was one of those times.

So, at this Wild Wolf Stampede there was an evening event, and at this evening event there were musical acts. The organizer of the Stampede hired a troupe of actors from Northern California who do this Grand Ole Opry Revival show, and they have all these actors that do skits in the interstitials, stuff they have pre-written and perform at other stampedes and country shows. They were doing pretty well. They have a core cast that travels but they hire local for the background color and Thomas and I got the gig where we stand in the background and dance and clap and encourage the other actors just like they used to do on the Grand Ole Opry back when it was black and white. Thomas even got to do a little two-step in one of the skits with this girl who basically impersonates June Carter. The act was super-cute, and I loved seeing Thomas out there with his cowboy shirt and his hat and his kerchief tied around his neck, his jeans tucked into these fancy cowboy boots Costume assigned to him.

The day before the Stampede starts, we're out at the venue all day running rehearsals with the group from Northern California while there're all these workers around doing last minute setup stuff. There were three guys who hung around enjoying seeing us all perform while they were still going around and tightening bolts and checking to make sure the stage setup was safe. These guys were local. Or at least, if they weren't, were Westerners in the real sense of the word. Cowboys. Kyler, Hayes, and Drew.

To me they were real live cowboys. Real men at least, whether they really worked with cattle, they looked the part. Young, tough, clean cut, big hands, hard bodies, but full of charm. No kidding, working all day with these guys around and it was Yes, ma'am, No, ma'am, and not just to me—Yes, sir, to other men, literally tipping their hat to women, holding doors, rushing to grab something if you were carrying it. It would be impossible not to like them.

We were around them all day, and they interacted with the performers, stopped to watch a dance number one time and applauded when the show was done. They were good guys. Even Thomas liked them.

Liked them enough he trusted them. And he shouldn't have.



At the end of rehearsal everyone was pooped, but yet were still amped, excited about tomorrow's show. A bunch of us actors were heading into town and we would hit the bar and dance and have some drinks. West Wolf was packed with early arrivers for the Stampede and attendees, so we figured it would be a wild and fun night. Thomas and I weren't exactly partiers, but we did love being social and there's a bonding that happens when you chill out with cast members so it wasn't a question we'd go out for drinks and dinner, but we figured, as usual, we'd be packing it in early to get a good night sleep.

Then it came down to finding a ride into town. The rodeo was on the outskirts of Wild Wolf at a private field, and town was at least fifteen minutes. We had sleep space in a camper on the grounds, but had hitched to West Wolf with one of the other actors from Missoula. So we had no personal transportation around West Wolf. Our ride from Missoula already had a packed vehicle by the time we got there, and then it was a hilarious scramble for all of us to find rides in vehicles with vacancies before they ran out, some of us running around with hands on hats to keep them in

place while we scurried. Our costumes had been surrendered to the Costume Department already, but those of us local actors had arrived in our Western gear already, so Costume just had to touch us up. Thomas had to surrender his hat and boots to Costume, so he was part Cowboy, part grad student, and I was wearing a country dress with triple layered ruffle skirts and my own cowboy boots.

I'm running through the grounds, scrambling over this grassy field trying not to break a leg while I catch an empty seat in a truck or car and someone grabs my wrist and hauls me around. It's Kyler, and he's got this charming smile, holding my arm and saying, "Hitch a ride with us, we're headed to town." He thumbs to this truck, but it's one of the Automobile Show trucks. There are a bunch of these old pickup trucks, glossy mint-condition vintage ones, low, with bulbous grills. He's pointing to one of them, a pickup with wooden rails around the bed and a load of straw bales (probably for show). There's two men in it up front, guys with short white sleeve collar shirts, wearing their Stetsons in the vehicle. Hayes and Drew are climbing in the bed, which isn't that big, hardly enough space it seems for all that straw and three men and me and Thomas. So I say to Kyler What about my husband as he's pulling me toward the back of the truck. Thomas shows up, calling my name, frantic, and I wave him over.

There's clearly no room. Barely room for me, never mind Thomas. But Hayes's standing on a straw bale, taller than the truck's cab, and he pounds a hand on the roof, leans to the driver side and tells him we got one more. The passenger door opens, and this old guy gets out so someone can climb on the bench seat. This truck has no back seats. The guy is smoking a cigarette and I figure he wants one of us in the middle so he can blow his smoke out the window. Thomas is telling me to get in the cab, and Kyler and Drew and Hayes are saying for me to get in the back. We'd been fooling around all day, me and those three, innocent and jokey stuff, but I could tell the guys liked me. And I hate cigarettes, more so than Thomas. And if you gave me a choice of sitting sandwiched between two old cowboys I've never met before who are going to smoke the whole ride into town or a trio of hot young cowboys riding in the bed of a vintage pickup from a rodeo to a honky-tonk the choice was pretty clear. No words between me and Thomas, I just gave him a face and a nose crinkle and he

laughed, knew what I meant and hopped into the cab, sandwiched between the old cowboys.

Kyler gets behind me, puts hands on my waist and hefts me up to the bed, Drew helping to pull me in safe and sound, all three young guys being careful of my safety, gentlemen that they were. Kyler takes my hand and guides me to walk on the straw bales and get a spot up by the back of the pickup's cab while Drew and Hayes take seats, folding arms over the tailgate, big hands thumping on the metal like a signal for the driver to get the show on the road. The truck lurches and I'm wobbly. Kyler hugs an arm around me and we both toss down onto the straw, me sitting in his lap.

Now I know right away a married woman sitting in another man's lap is not a good idea. But there's literally no other place for me. Anywhere in the back of the truck, I'm going to be touching one of these cowboys. So if I sit in his lap, at least I'm comfortable. But even though I have no plan for anything to go on with any of them, I feel myself hiding from Thomas if he were to look around into the bed. If he did, he'd see the back of Kyler's cowboy hat, part of my hair, maybe, plus straw and more straw. I doubt he'd see the other two guys unless he rose up and peered. I hunkered down to hide myself a little and Kyler puts his arm around me. I don't stop him though I should have. It's a weird thing where you know better but you start to think, What's the harm, you know? I like this guy Kyler. All three of them were nice all day. Guys and girls can be friends in this world. Not everything is about sex. Even if the guys are good-looking cowboys. That's what I thought, at least.

Did I enjoy sitting back there with them? Yes. In a way a married woman shouldn't? Yes. Unfortunately.

Look, they were cute. Honest, it seemed. Hard working. And I checked them out a little in the way a woman might do and not think it a big deal. Tight jeans, firm slim asses, big shoulders . . . and man hands. You know how rare a real man hand is when you're in drama and Anthro? I liked being around them. I didn't have dirty thoughts during the day when I saw them. I mean, not really. You see things, they register, sometimes a thought will amuse you. I'm not a crotch watcher, not at all. But cowboy jeans sit a certain way, and cowboys wear them snug. They had the belts with the big

buckles and your eyes sometimes just go there. All of them had fine male bodies that looked beautiful in their denim, but Kyler in particular really filled out the front of his pants. I mean, if you were really looking, maybe you could see the large shape of his penis. I didn't fall all over him when I'd noticed earlier, in fact I'd looked away real quick. Whatever was in the crotch of his pants, all I could think of sitting on his lap in the back of that old pickup was that I swore I could feel it against my ass.

The ride from the stage section across the rodeo grounds took almost fifteen minutes because there were so many vehicles all leaving at the same time. Everybody hooting and hollering, honking horns and in good spirits. It's summer. It's warm. It's that golden light as the sun just begins to descend. Drew and Hayes shout at other trucks, yelling at other cowboys they knew. Good natured. That rutted grassy field bounced the truck all around, and I jostled in Tyler's lap. Bouncing against his thighs. He had long legs, the denim soft and faded. I could feel it against the back of my calves. Even though the new Grand Ole Opry show was fashioned after the way it used to be in the 1950s, the modern revival still wanted the girls to show some leg. So I was dressed demurely, but my skirt wasn't to my ankles. It came just below my knees to show off part of my calves and my cowboy boots I quite liked. And sitting in Kyler's lap like that had my legs folded up. Knees together so that Drew and Hayes could look up my skirt. The whole while in that armada of slow-moving vehicles trying to leave the rodeo and get into town, I would catch them sneaking looks at my bare legs. I hate that I liked it.

To steady me, Kyler had put a hand on my waist. So my back was to his chest, and one of those big hands that I admired all day had a good firm grip at my middle. I could feel his fingertips pressing. Could feel his thumb against the small of my back. And I was 24, tight as a drum, and there was a certain pride in knowing that he probably liked the feel of my body under his hand, too. This is probably where the bad stuff begins. It was when I started to think in return that I liked to be appreciated.

So it was single file now, all of us going down a country road, and these old cowboys I was with were convinced, I figured, they knew a shortcut. We weren't the only ones taking the shortcut, but we were at the end of the pack. A lineup of maybe half a dozen cars and trucks taking a rutted path through what looked like a farmer's field. The road was so rough they

couldn't go fast, and we just ended up knocking and bouncing around back there. Enough it had us all laughing. Drew and Hayes held hands over their cowboy hats to keep them from popping off and losing them. But I was bouncing up and down, right in Kyler's lap. The suggestiveness of it was obvious. It looked like we were getting our jollies.

He raised his knees to brace me in position better, but it put the softness of my butt against the generous pouch that I'd noticed earlier in the front of his jeans. And for a while, I kept thinking about it but trying to push it out of my head. His hand on me, the way he held me against him, the straight up and down jack hammering of my butt against his crotch . . . it was a blatant mimicking of us fucking.

Then there was a right turn out of that farmer's field and down a tree-lined road the twisted and wound. When it was quieter, we were able to talk a little, joke around with each other about how rough the ride had been. Drew took off his hat and whacked it against his knee, saying he'd like to see one of those bull riders handle that. I agreed, and Kyler put both hands on my waist and said, "I think you could ride a bull just fine, Miss Jackie." I asked him what he meant, and he said, "The way you were bouncing on me." And I did a timid curtsy while staying seated in his lap, playing it up. But definitely feeling flushed. My fake curtsy flashed up the hem of my skirt and showed off my upper thighs for just a tick of a second. Drew and Hayes hooted like they'd been driving cattle for months on end and hadn't seen a woman in a while.

They were honest and funny about their appreciation, and it didn't offend me. It riled me. There was something about their male energy that teased at my soft feminine side. While they were still regaling, pretending to clutch their hearts as if they loved what they saw, I flashed them another one to see what other funny reaction I could provoke. They fanned their faces and mocked fainting—and then Kyler's huge, strong hands held up my skirt, stopping me from closing it back down again. And I didn't feel threatened, I didn't feel offended, I felt that same feeling again: appreciated. I shot my legs out straight, let them take a look. I had nice legs. I let them look. Tyler held the skirt up, his hand clutched up near the quarter top third of my thigh, revealing to Drew and Hayes my straightened legs from mid thigh

down. There were small tiny scratches along the right side of my legs which had a fairly decent tan (being August), and he ran his thumb over them, like he worried about the little marks from riding on straw. He said, "Better keep you protected, the straw wants to tear you up." He raised his knees. My legs rode on top of his, the backs of my knees against his kneecaps. And as Drew and Hayes watched, Kyler moved outward his legs, and my legs riding on top of his went opening along. It gave Drew and Hayes a flash up my skirt and showed them my panties. For whatever reason, I didn't throw back an elbow, I didn't whomp on the back window of the pickup truck and tell that old timer to stop. I laughed along with them, like I enjoyed it as much as they did. I thrust both my hands downward over my crotch to cover myself up. But I was laughing just the same.

Kyler's hands stroked my sides, then they moved down over mine. I let mine come up, and I put them over top of his. I'd given this hot cowboy control over my skirt. And I got to explore the shapes of those big man hands. Mine were so small and soft and pale over top of his. Big knuckles, thick fingers. Hard working hands. I watched as his fingers wrangled up handfuls of skirt, drawing it higher and higher. My legs were still out, bent over his knees and open.

"You gonna show those boys again?" Kyler said, and his voice was near my ear, low and grumbling. The moment was so filled with humor I didn't feel like it was anything more than a naughty violation. This wasn't terrible, it was just joking around like high school. He flipped my skirt up and back down again so quick his friends wouldn't have been able to see. But it got my stomach jumping, and Drew and Hayes were laughing so hard, leaning to the side trying to get a peek. All of us having fun. Just joking around, right? I mean, my husband was right behind me. Sure, he probably wouldn't like what we were doing. But something else happened in this moment, and it kind of, I guess, changed everything . . . That soft but generous package I could feel under my right butt cheek wasn't so soft anymore. There was an uncomfortable feeling, like I had sat on something hard. Like there was something poking against the soft muscle of my ass and grinding into my tailbone. I knew what it was . . .

If you asked me now what I would think of a married woman sitting in another man's lap, and that man was getting aroused, my answer would be straightforward. I don't know what was wrong with me then. I really am not like this. Whatever was happening that day, I found the feeling arousing. Intoxicating.

I pretended like I didn't notice his arousal. I even leaned back against him a little, trying to put more pressure on it. I could feel the hard column of it splitting my ass cheeks through the soft cotton of that country dress I was wearing. And I didn't close my legs either.

Kyler joked around, performing for his hungry audience, inching the skirt higher, and I let him. We jostled side to side on that country road, two cowboys as my audience waiting to get a look up my skirt and see my panties. The skirt came higher and higher, until Kyler had it bunched in those two large hands, my hands on top of his. Not stopping him, not closing over those big fists and stopping him. Just sitting in his lap and watching those guys's expressions.

He pulled on my skirt and held it up. Let his friends look between my legs. This is where I knew things had changed. But I didn't want to stop. There was something about it that still allowed me to feel safe. These guys were decent. We were having fun. My husband was nearby. It sounds totally crazy, but without this precise ingredient list, the recipe would have failed. Everything lined up that day and I made a terrible mistake.

I liked their eyes on me. I let them look between my legs. My heart was racing, my breath was coming in hard and fast. I had my legs open and hot men were looking up my skirt. And it didn't stop there. Kyler's hand palmed the top of my right thigh, his fingertips curled over the inside, his

thumb touching that strap of cloth where the panties crossed my hip. I knew he was going to touch me; I knew it. I still didn't close my legs.

Sure enough, his hand eased into that apex, and now my legs gently closed, just a little, the insides of my thighs pressing against that huge hand of his as his fingers touched my pussy over top of the fabric. I pushed my skirt down to cover for a moment, and the look of disappointment on Drew and Hayes's face had me lifting it again. Kyler began to rub his fingers against the soft shapes, and I knew that I would be wet. I can clearly remember the panties I wore that day. Remember even the store where I bought them. I can see the color in my mind's eye. A pale rose. I remember sitting in his lap and thinking how noticeable the stain of my wetness would be. Instead of shame, I hoped that it would arouse them.

I watched their faces while their cowboy friend fingered me over my underwear. Their expressions had changed. Gone was the hilarity. Their faces showed hunger. It had changed in me too, though I couldn't see my face, I knew in my heart that this wasn't "funny" anymore. And I knew that the expression they held was similar to what I felt. Hunger.

When Kyler tucked fingers underneath my panties and shoved them aside, I gasped. Didn't slap my legs closed, I let him show his friends my naked pussy. I can remember the way those cowboys shifted uncomfortably, like they were getting hard, and their pants—God, those tight jeans—were getting uncomfortable, their growing hardness's pressing against the too-tight denim.

They were looking at my bare pussy. Their friend fingered it. Kyler put his finger right inside me. My husband right behind me, sitting in the truck cab in billows of cigarette smoke with two guys he didn't even know. My wonderful husband. Kyler teased, tapped, poked, prodded, fingered. He pulled out his wet fingers and I could feel myself gushing. Spread my petals open to show his friends my insides. I squirmed in his hard cowboy lap. Squirmed like this action being performed wasn't terrible. Squirmed like this wasn't a big mistake. Squirmed because I loved it.

My hand went down, grabbed his leg, and I shifted. That hardness I'd felt against my ass cheeks had turned iron and I wanted to see it. And as soon as

I shifted aside, it was like he knew. He switched hands, fingering me with his left, I scooted into the clutch of his arm while his right hand undid his belt buckle. I kneaded the denim bulge like I couldn't wait. When he unzipped his pants, I shoved my hand in the opening. It was all hot, hard flesh. No underwear. The denim could barely contain it, and it practically burst out of the open fly. I remember thinking like it had been choking in there and it came out gasping and heaving for breath. It was enormous. I can still sometimes feel it in my hand because it was so shocking. Long, yes, but so incredibly thick. It felt like a hot club in my hand and I wondered how a man could be so wide and still enter a woman . . .

All that fun energy had leaked away. It was just pure lust left.

In my hand was another man's cock. Witnesses were there, taking it in. Party to this woman's sudden and unexpected betrayal. And in that moment, instead of wanting to stop, I was raced with this feeling of urgency. In the back of my mind, knowing we must be getting close to this honky-tonk bar. Like there was something I wanted to do, and I wanted it done, but I knew I was running out of time. It was like I was on autopilot. The actions don't seem to me now like thoughts that I made logically. They were just human female reaction. A young woman in the presence of a very viable young man, fooling around until things got to the point where our sexes became engorged. And then it was just like natural biology took over. I wanted him. I was dripping for him. And his hardness in my hand told me he wanted me. He leaked. A lot. I remember feeling it warm, trickling over the back of my hand, making his massive size slippery. And all four of us were party to this. All of us looking around now, making sure the coast was clear, shifting so my back was to the window my husband could look out. I dug my heels in the straw, lifted my butt up, and Kyler hoisted my skirt so that my ass was bare against his open fly. I could feel that hard, hot cock against my bare skin now. I never wanted a cock inside me as bad as I did right then.

There's a single image that stays with me. Kyler's hat. I can see it traveling over my shoulder, past my bare legs and down to my cowboy boots. He'd tossed it for safekeeping to his friends. And they (like two good cowboys) scrambled to catch it, Hayes taking it and clutching it to his chest protectively. Hayes sat with one leg stretched out, his inside calf touching

the outside of my calf, his other leg bent, his knee pulled high. I could see the outline of his erection in his jeans.

Kyler's hands went from my knees up my naked thighs, scooted under my rump and lifted me up. With my heels pushing down again, I lifted so he could guide me onto him, my hands going down to take the underside of his incredibly wide erection and guiding the bulbous point of it into my opening. He sat me on it, then my own body weight had it sinking inside my body. It was so huge it hurt. I remember my face scrunching up in a snarl because it felt like someone was trying to push a fist up inside me. I loved it. I was wetter than believable. And with the jostling of the truck, my own body weight began to settle downward on it, its rigid length forced inside of my body. My ass muscles cramped as I dug my heels in, trying to slow my descent on something that hurt so bad—and yet I wanted inside me so eagerly. I felt like I tore when I finally sat on it. My legs open, the heels of my cowboy boots planted, knees touching, ankles against the insides of Kyler's thighs. His hands went up my ribs, cupped my breasts over my denim shirt. He flexed his stomach, and that pushed it deeper; the truck bounced, and I shifted on it. And then we were fucking. We used the bouncy road. Kyler lifted me up and down with his hands on my waist, sometimes hooking both arms around me and squeezing my breasts. I panted and cried, but forced my eyes to stay open. I looked at Drew's and Hayes's arousal through their jeans. Both of them were large, too. They rubbed the hard shapes of their erections over their denim. If it had been a longer ride, sometimes I wonder if I would've let them take their turns as well. That's how out of my mind I was.

I knew we had to be fast, so within minutes I was jacking myself on it, jumping in his lap while his friend's watched their buddy's huge cock go in and out of me. I was amazed that I could get his huge thing inside me and that it felt so good. But it did. I can't lie, it really did. Kyler's cock stands out in my memory as the single most lubricious beacon from my past. There are times at night I'll masturbate and I still think about how he felt inside me.

I came. It wasn't the mastery of my lover. It was the salacious experience. The badness. This sudden thunderclap of lust that shocked me. I remember

slapping my knees closed together, squirming with his huge size impaled in me, and I think it was the act of my orgasm that triggered him. Because he leaned forward then, his chest pushing into my back, and drove his hips up, ramming himself into me all the way to his balls. And I knew he was coming inside me.

The only person who'd ever come inside me in my life was Thomas. And now this cowboy I've known for about twelve hours had his huge cock inside me and was ejaculating with abandon. I could feel it flexing and cabling, could feel his additional wet very deep inside me. We didn't use a condom. I wasn't on the pill. Thomas and I used the rhythm method, and when the time wasn't so great Thomas would wear a condom. Thomas had used a condom with me two days before. It wasn't a good time for someone to come inside me. I didn't even care.

It's not like Kyler came inside me, and I suddenly clutched my temples and screeched out at the tremendous mistake I had made. Lust still sizzled through me. Burned its way through sense and logic, and I didn't mind that this hot cowboy had done that.

Then we felt the truck slowing, all of us scrambling suddenly, doing that looking around thing again, eyes wide and alert. Hayes covered his erection showing through his jeans with Kyler's hat. Drew untucked his shirt. I knew right then I could get away with this. It didn't seem like they were going to rat me out. It hurt when Kyler pulled it out of me, and I stood on wobbly legs as the truck pulled into the honky-tonk amidst all our friends coming down the road and filling the parking lot, shouting and honking horns. Our shortcut had us beating them there after all.

Kyler's seed trickled down the inside of my leg, and I straightened my skirt, smoothed my hand down the front, tugged my panties over to cover my injured sex. My fingers touched where I'd been penetrated and I could feel how he'd left me engorged, tugged, and so very wet. I had no time for regret. No time for shame. That was probably a blessing. Truck doors were opening, Drew and Hayes were standing up, Hayes still covering his bulge with Kyler's hat. Kyler was buckling up his belt as Thomas was coming around. Drew took my waist and helped me out. I could see his hard cock in his pants and hoped Thomas wasn't looking there.

It hurt between my legs when I had to hook my cowboy boot over the tailgate and have my husband help me down. My rump was in his face and I imagined he could smell my sex, could smell his wife's arousal. He didn't. Another man pleased my sex with his size, but I was in my husband's arms. My cheeks must've been flushed, but Thomas would've thought that would be from the bouncy, winding ride in the back of the pickup truck. He had his arm around me and he asked the cowboys, "Aren't you guys coming in?"

The cowboys were all gracious and polite smiles and Aw, shucks and No, sirs, Drew saying to my husband, "Wish we could—we got stuff to do with these boys where the farm we're stayin'," nodding his head aside to the chain smokers in the pickup's cab. Kyler snatched his hat from Hayes who had ducked down again, squatted in the back of the truck, put on his hat and knocked it back from his forehead, leaning his elbow on a straw bale, smiling and saying right to me: "Maybe, we'll see you around tomorrow, Miss Jackie."

Part 3

Outro

I fold up the printed emails, showing on my face the lamentation for the lack of closure I would've expected to end such a wonderful email.

Jacqueline chewed her cheek for a second, looking at me, looking away, then looking back at me. "I lost steam," she said.

I laugh, put the folded up sheets back in my satchel. I push away my finished plate, rest my forearms on the table. "You left me wondering if you saw them again. What happened the next day?"

She's uncomfortable, but knows she came here to talk about this. She takes a breath, says, "I pretended I was sick."

"You didn't do the show?"

She shook her head. "I was so worried. So worried I would see those guys again . . . and just lose it, you know? Have a nervous breakdown. I couldn't build the nerve. I'd hate to hurt my Thomas."

"So you missed out on your own show?"

"I know, it's terrible," she said, frowning. She palmed her forehead, eyes staring in the middle of the table as she remembered. "I told Thomas I had a fever. When we woke up in the morning, it was the first thing I said. But I wasn't feeling well. I was tired, my stomach hurt—it was all in knots. So much fear what I'd done would be discovered. Then I got up, thinking I would fight through it. I really didn't feel well. My stomach was all twisted up . . . it was this anxious roller coaster. One second thinking I could do it. the next practically throwing myself down on the bed wishing I was asleep again."

"So you didn't see them again?"

She shook her head no. “It’s better that way, anyway.”

When I see the turmoil she’s entered into, I don’t like it. I say to her, “So tell me about this dick again.”

She chuckles and her face brightens. She’s still staring into the center of the table, unseeing, her mind’s eye probably focused on the recollection of some cowboy’s big tree trunk. She groans then, pats at her cheeks and hides her face for a moment. She peeps at me through her open hands, looking up at me through her brows. She’s adorable. Those cowboys didn’t have a chance. She said, “It was like holding on to a man’s wrist.”

“That’s hot,” I said.

She laughs at my answer, knowing my history. She is a fan.

Then she laughs and groans again before leaning close and saying to me, “but like a strong man. You know? One with muscles.”

“This is the reason I write these stories,” I say slyly and leaned closer to her too, pretending to fan myself. Now we’re two girls over the middle of a table talking conspiratorially over our maple syrup plates.

“I’d never seen one like that,” she said.

“So how”—my voice lowers to a whisper—“thick?” I move my fingers in a vague circle.

“I don’t know. Like crazy. Like a can of Red Bull.”

“I’m familiar,” I say. I like a happy Jacqueline better than the sullen one. So now when I sit back, I put an elbow over the IHOP bench seat. I say, “Imagine if that ride was longer? Maybe all three of them . . .”

Then she’s hiding her face again, laughing into her hands. She peeks at me again. “It’s not so crazy, right?”

“You should see the letters I get.”

She nods. “I felt guilty for the longest time. And then mad at myself for feeling guilty. And then mad at myself when I didn’t feel guilty enough.”

“I don’t know why it happens,” I say.

“I was hoping you had answers.”

“I’m still doing research,” I say.

She nods again, nibbling on her lower lip, then begins to gather herself, doing up the zipper on her jacket.

“You gotta go?”

“You can email me if you want. Sorry—I told you I don’t have much time this morning.”

“Thomas has the boys,” I say.

And boom. There’s that sullen look again. It suddenly occurs to me that in one of our preliminary emails, she said she had two boys. One’s in Grade 2. That would place him at seven. Now my own stomach squirmed at the notion that this woman might always wonder if when her seven-year-old grows up he might have a knack for busting broncos.

The moment’s uncomfortable, and I feel like she knows what I’m thinking. I don’t want her to feel ashamed. I say, “Hey, I’m real glad that you managed to make it this morning. I loved talking to you.”

“Thank you. I’m glad I made it, too.”

“Before you go, one last thing: Was it worth it?”

She smirks, rolls her eyes up to the light above our table. Thinking about it. “You know what?—seven years later now, I think it was. I go back and forth.”

“You’ll probably always go back and forth.”

Her expression goes serious. “I really do love my husband.” She says it earnestly, leaning close to me, one hand squeezing on the tricep of her other arm. She’s worried that I think she’s bad.

“That’s the whole point of this,” I say. “I know you love your husband. It wouldn’t be interesting if you didn’t.”

“These women you talk to, are they bad people?”

“You’re not bad.”

“What about the others?”

I shrug. “I haven’t met all of them yet. Who knows? . . . Emails are one thing, I like to look somebody in the eye.”

“And what’s your verdict on me?”

I don’t know how to answer. I don’t know what she means. I tell her she’s good, but it’s not what she wanted to hear. She gives me a polite smile, leans close, and touches me. Pats my wrist with her hand. I see her wedding ring. I feel like she’s proud of it. I know that deep in her heart she loves her family and her husband more than anything. But I also know that deep in her heart she wishes she could have enjoyed her time in the back of that truck better. I even wonder if she’s ever considered telling Thomas. Or has ever wondered if she’d cleared it with Thomas first if he’d let her. . . . Boy, that would be something.

“Okay,” she says, “I gotta scoot. The boys have to get to school and I’m not even in the shower yet.”

“You want a ride?”

“Yeah, right,” she says, “how’d I explain that one?”

“To Thomas? he doesn’t know who’s in the car, remember I’m just one of the fun moms from school.”

“In an airport rental? Thomas isn’t dumb.” She zips up her jacket to her neck, and she’s listening to her own words back. No, her husband’s not dumb. And now she’s thinking she’s treating him like he is. I wonder if she’ll ever tell him. Maybe when my book comes out . . .

Then she’s off, and I’m getting another cup of coffee. I watch her trot past my airport rental, peeking inside, trying to gauge the life of a writer famous for writing about penises. Then she’s back on the sidewalk, running off to my left until I can’t see her anymore.

Kristy and the Patient

Part 1

Intro

The woman I'm calling Kristy was a hard one to figure right from the beginning. The most cryptic of emails. I wondered if she worked for the Department of Defense. It was like she didn't want to commit anything to writing, but knew she had the juicy goods. I was like Woodward and Bernstein getting tidbits from Deep Throat. Her introductory email subject heading sure was a cracker.

I gave a hand job to my daughter's ex-boyfriend

How would I not click on that?

We danced around a little, Kristy and I, a shorthand mambo of emails with few words, and this woman lets me know the parameters of our discussion. Just about the only one out of all the gaggle of women who sent me lewd missives about their one time with that one guy with the big . . .

I agree to meet her at a cocktail bar in Manhattan. A quick taxi ride from my apartment, not much for me to expense on this one. It's the Marble Chute on the third floor of the Sussex Hotel, a guests-only private room. This is where my expense account might come back into play. Cocktails are \$30 easy. Kristy is a player. I kind of saw it coming.

It's 6:30 on a Thursday, and I'm early. Kristy is earlier. I see this woman as I come into the place, telling the attendant I just want to sit at the bar. I already know it's her. It's the posture, it's the combed back blonde hair that's cut short and sensible, yet somehow alluring. Her hair is not long, it's thick and straight. It's that pale kind of blonde and it's authentic; the style shows off the geometry of her angular face. She's got it brushed back

behind one ear. Her diamond earring is probably very real. Her hair hangs down in a slash, parted at the side and swoops to cover one eye. While we talked that day, she was always moving it aside. It was a practiced and careful gesture she did. She's not tall, but she looks it. She's lean with long legs. Style and grace, expensive clothes and a Cartier watch. She doesn't wave me over. She doesn't need to and knows it. I'm drawn to her. It's the first time I've done one of these meetings with someone where I feel anxious to be with them. She says, "Glad you could make it," doesn't get up, and doesn't offer me her hand.

I say, "I take it you're Kristy."

"Of course I am, Hannah," she says, "can I get you a drink?"

That's how it starts. In control right from the start. Right from the first sentence. Right from when I walked in the bar . . .

The two of us sit on comfortable stools with seatbacks at the massive mahogany bar under halogen lights. It's busy, but we're not cramped. The Marble Chute limits the number of guests. I asked her if she's in town on business.

"I am."

"What is it you do?"

She doesn't like the question, but considers it for a half second and doesn't see the harm. "I own a business. With my husband."

"What kind of business?"

She's not sure she wants to answer. She says, "Distributing." (She didn't say distributing, btw, but you get the picture).

We get our drinks, and I see that small talk isn't going to happen. She doesn't care enough about me. I wonder how she's a fan of mine.

"Make it quick," she says of my just-arrived cocktail, "I thought I could talk in here, but now I don't want to."

She's ordered me a Whiskey Sour, and now I have to down it fast. She downs hers before me, makes no grimace. She taps a finger on the counter, and the barman nods. Then she looks to me, asking if I'm ready to go.

I take another swig (I had to do mine in two gulps), then we're in the elevator, going up. It's a small cabin and we're the only two people in it. We don't talk. I watch her from the corner of my eye. She has a nice jawline and a beautiful face. I put her mid-40s. I wonder when this hand job event occurred. We get off on the 17th floor, she leads the way and I follow. We're in her room then, and it's opulent. Great view of the city. I'm super envious. It isn't a big space, but it is luxurious. She gestures for me to take a seat on the leather couch. I do.

She's tossing off her jacket, saying, "Last thing I thought I was going to do was invite you up here."

"You really thought you could spill your guts in the bar?"

"I thought I'd back out altogether."

"That disappoints me," I say.

"I'm sure it would."

I point-blank ask her: "How are you a fan of mine?"

She thinks about it, then comes to sit in the single fat leather chair across from me. She crosses one leg over the other, draping elegant hands over the armrests. She said, "Google search."

"For little old me?"

"No. I would say it's the subject matter I was searching."

I get saucy. "What do you like better? Me or the subject matter?" I already know the answer, but I'm trying to get past her defenses. It disarms her a little.

She moves her eyes around, not going to answer my stupid question, but I can feel like I'm drawing her closer to me. She leans forward, putting her elbows on her knees, both feet on the floor. She looks at me steadily. "For a while, I thought I had a problem . . ."

"A big dick problem?" I say, raising an eyebrow.

"I thought you'd matured," she said.

"I'm sorry," I say, actually getting serious now. "You put me on edge."

"You can be at ease," she says. She would've done great in the military.

I say, "So this thing happened with your daughter's ex-boyfriend, and then you thought you had a problem?"

"It started before him." Now she's forthcoming. Leaning back again, crossing her legs over to keep a shield between us, letting a little light out of her box but still wanting to have control of the lid. She said, "I always did. I guess I . . . I always did. But I went to an all-girl school."

"A good one."

She looks at me, not liking to be interrupted, meanwhile her eyes are saying Of course it was a good school. She continues then. "Prep school, too—all-girls."

"And college? All-girls?"

She nods. "I was a virgin until I graduated."

"No offense, but I find it hard to believe."

"Why is that?"

"You strike me as somebody who knows what they want and doesn't have problems getting what they want."

“That’s only when you’re sure what you want makes sense. Success makes sense. Strange and sick desires don’t.”

Now she’s gone foggy, talking to me but her mind elsewhere. The scary bitch is a size queen and she’s just coming to terms with it. I would fucking love to say it to her just to watch her jolt, but I’m afraid of what she would do to me.

I say, being nice, “You should see the letters I get. It’s not sick. There’s nothing wrong. You like what you like. Some of us get turned on by size . . .”

Kristy’s still off somewhere, contemplating. Probably reliving all those years tucked into dorms at girls’ academies when she could have been at a coed, cock shopping.

“Anyway,” she said, and I realize a whole story had been playing out in her head that she didn’t share with me. She’s engaged again, taking a deep breath and looking at me. “I had a boyfriend before my husband . . .”

“And what? He was big?”

“No. Small, I guess. And then Mike . . .”

“Well, that would make him bigger.”

“Right. It wasn’t till after we were married . . . I just didn’t feel . . .”

“Like you had enough experiences?”

She shook her head in small, slow wags. “No. Satisfied. It’s weird,” she said, her voice getting draggy as she considered it. She pulls her hair away from her eyes, not looking at me, talking to the table between us. “I don’t think I’d ever seen another penis. Two boys. But then I started thinking about them . . .”

“How old were you?”

“After we were married? I was twenty-four.”

“And just out of the blue started thinking about penises?”

“There were other little tidbits of information that filtered my way. You know, at a girl school, everybody talks. But without ever seeing what they were talking about or knowing, I didn’t know what to believe . . . who were the liars and who were the braggarts . . . and, no, I know you’re wondering—I never looked at porn. I was left to speculate . . .”

“I get it.”

“Yes, you do. You seem to have it all figured out.”

“Jealous?” I asked her.

Now she smiles for the first time, and I feel like I’m making a connection. Her hair is falling forward again, and she brushes it back. “I do wish I’d had a different experience in school.”

“Should have gone coed.”

“Should have. My parents were probably worried I’d turn out like this.”

“There’s nothing wrong with you.”

“You read my email . . . what I did . . .”

“You wouldn’t tell me what happened. Just teased me.”

“Okay,” she said, “Yes. All right . . . I wouldn’t put in writing.”

“I’m dying to hear it . . . and we’re all alone . . .”

Part 2

Kristy's Story

Kristy prepares herself for her confessional, clapping her hands together between her knees. She's sitting forward, with her elbows across her thighs—a standard pose, but one that doesn't befit her. I can tell what she's about to reveal to me jangles her in ways she doesn't like. She's a woman in control, and whatever happened with this ex-boyfriend of her daughter's, it's unsettled her. It was a time where she didn't have control. And, I figure, she's worried it could happen again. From what she's already revealed, it could happen with this ex-boyfriend of her daughter's again, or perhaps some other man who crosses her path, swinging something that catches her eye.

One second in, and Kristy can't continue. "Hey, let me fix us a drink."

I tell her I wouldn't mind one and sit on the couch and watch her. She's up, moving to the room's minibar, a stainless steel and padded leather column with mirrored shelves. She takes her time, fidgeting, going through the bottles, taking her time making the correct choice. There's a bowl of fresh-cut lemon, and whatever she brings me, she pops a wedge into the glass first. I don't ask what it is, but I can smell the whiskey.

She sits down, takes a sip, leans back and crosses her legs again. "All right," she continues, "there's this boy from the neighborhood . . ." I can see she doesn't like the sound of that, and she makes a face and corrects herself: "Young man. This young man from the neighborhood . . ." She shakes her head. She can't believe what transpired. It makes me anxious to hear the details.

Another sip of her whiskey, then: "I know this young man's mother. You know, from parent-teacher, sports activities . . . We were both involved on a few committees at the kids' high school." Now she's chewing her lip, looking out at the view through the windows behind the mini bar. "So, I'm

friendly with this guy's mother. His name is Ryan. Ryan's a . . . Ryan's a good kid. Really good looking"—the pause is enormous—"In high school, my daughter dated him. She dated Ryan. I guess she would've been sixteen. Sixteen all the way to eighteen. They broke up after high school. Before college. It was amicable enough. Well, I shouldn't say that. No. My daughter was . . . devastated." She touches hair away from her eye. "She took a day. Then she put her chin up. Anyway, that was a while ago. They've both been in different colleges for three years now. Both of them have moved on." She takes another sip. The ice cubes tinkle. I sip mine. It's strong.

Kristy continues. "I hadn't seen Ryan in the longest time. A very long time. Not since he'd gone to college. So, anyway, Mike and I—my husband—were in Colorado on a business trip. We're in the middle of the convention, I get a phone call. It's Ryan's mom. She's frantic. Knows Mike and I are in Colorado, and wants somebody to go to the hospital. Ryan's hurt himself. I'm telling her to calm down, that I'll do what I can. I asked what happened, she said he was in Telluride, he was skiing. She doesn't know what happened, but they took him away in a helicopter. This alarms me. So I tell her that I'll get right over. Mike and I abandon the show, we headed to Boulder Hospital, which is where Ryan's mom said he'd be. We're not family, but we go up and we do what we can at administration. They tell us he's okay. I say that his mom sent us to find out what happened and if he needs anything. I was worried we would face an impasse, but they were understanding. In retrospect, I think Ryan probably charmed a lot of those young women working there. So the woman at the counter tells me Ryan's fine. He's broken his arms. Well, a fracture in one, a sprain in the other. Both forearms. I ask if we can see him, she says we can. Mike's parked out front, so I tell him I'm going to go up, and he's going to go park the car."

As she takes another sip of her whiskey cocktail I'm starting to get tight with anticipation. This thing happens with Mike present, or with Mike looming, his arrival imminent? Time sensitivity is astoundingly hot. I urge her to continue.

She puts up a hand to steady me. She's telling the story at her own pace.

“So I go up. Ryan’s on the fifth floor. Beautiful sunny day. He’s got a private room. His parents have a lot of money. He’s all by himself in this big room, this view of blue sky Colorado and the mountains out his window. I come up to his bed, see he’s sleeping. He’s got both his arms in casts, so only his fingers are sticking out. And for the moment, I’m thinking of him in a maternal sort of way. Looking at his poor well-groomed fingers, worried about the pain he might be in, lamenting that his road to recovery might be too long. Then I admire his sleeping face. He’s twenty-one now. He’s grown into a handsome young man. Astounding really. Almost a perfect face. His eyes are closed, but I know they’re a sort of ocean shade of blue.”

She’s touching her neck as she tells me this. She really has a thing for this kid.

“And these pouting lips. Like the color of a berry. Never seen lips like that.” Now she shakes her head, getting back to the task at hand. “I guess one of the nurses had been in to do his bedpan. His lap blanket’s pulled down mid-thigh. Ryan’s hospital robe is riding high. He’s laying there placid as can be, eyes closed, his hands are held out like a mummy. He’s reclining, legs lightly parted.”

I swallow . . .

“He’s not wearing anything under his hospital gown. I can see his . . . boy parts.”

It surprises me to hear terms so immature from such a mature woman. Like she’s reverting to the time when she was sexualized. When her sexuality is heightened, she reverts to the lingo of her most erotic age. “And . . .?”

She looks at me. “What do you think?”

“Tell me.”

She rolls her head around. This is what we came together for, but now we’re here she’s having second thoughts again. It’s funny because Kristy

doesn't seem like a timid woman with second thoughts. She takes a deep breath.

"I mean, I've never seen anything like it. There, between his legs, I can see everything he was blessed with. And it was . . . so much. This huge sleepy penis. And it's draped over his testicles. They're big too. Just . . . like eggs," she says, shaking her hands, trying to find the right words to describe what she saw that drove her so crazy. "And his skin is flawless. I mean all over his body. But his penis skin is . . . his penis is like this perfect thing. I can't believe how big it is. I mean, I'm literally astounded." She's shaking her head now, touching just below her belly button. "I've never felt like that before. Never seen anything that provoked such strange feelings in me . . ."

"I know it."

She sighed, running her hands together. "I guess that's why I wrote to you. I don't know who else to talk to."

"You can always talk to a professional."

"A therapist? I know my therapist. I'm not going to tell them this. What would she think of me?"

"I don't think it's as terrible a thing as you're making it."

"I know. That's why I read your articles. I don't want to think I'm crazy."

"You're not crazy at all, I swear."

“You haven’t heard the crazy part yet.”

“I know. I want you to tell me.”

It takes her another moment, but finally she lets out a long exhale and continues. “I take this long look, taking advantage of him sleeping. I’m standing there admiring his penis, like a . . . like a lech. A creep.”

“You’re not a creep.”

“This is the boy—a man now—but when he was a boy, he was my daughter’s boyfriend. They must have had sex together. Maybe not, but . . . sixteen to eighteen? There’s a pretty good chance my daughter might have even had her first sexual experience with him.”

“It’s going to be downhill from there,” I say, but Kristy doesn’t like my attempt at humor.

“I’m a terrible person for standing there gawking at his privates. Anyway, after I curse myself out for doing it, I reach down to tug his gown’s hem, and now my hand is so near to it. I imagine for a second I could get away with touching it, but I don’t do it. I put my hand down and hold the hem of his gown, but I’m taking my time, and I realize I’m still studying his genitals. Admiring them. I look up to his face and Ryan’s not asleep anymore. He’s watching me.” She grumbles and covers her face for a second before regaining her composure. “It’s so obvious, I think. I just got caught looking, and my hand is down there. I can feel shame, like hot shame, roasting my cheeks. I bring my hand back”—she holds her hand to her chest, like she’s re-enacting the moment—“and we share this awkward moment. I’m hoping he doesn’t know his penis is exposed, maybe he’s just bewildered by my presence. And sure enough, he starts talking like he hadn’t just caught me about to touch his penis. We make the expected small

talk—how am I there in Colorado, and I tell him how I'm there on business and how his mother called me. I tell him his mother will be there soon. And, I tell him, Mike will be up in a minute, he's just parking the car."

"Did he know you were looking?"

"No, I don't think so. Not at first."

"Not at first?"

"I looked again while we were talking and he got curious, leaning forward. But he was immobilized by the way he was sitting with his arms in braces, and he couldn't tell his penis was exposed."

"So he didn't know."

Kristy sighs, says, "A breeze shot down out of a vent in the ceiling, a warm blast that I could feel rustle my hair. Ryan's eyes go wide. His face goes red, even under his tan. His mouth works to say something, but his mind is elsewhere. Probably between his legs."

"He could feel the breeze on his dick?"

"Yes," she says, nodding, lips pursed. "He realizes I can see his penis and there's nothing he can do about it because of the way his arms are rigged up. I'm too embarrassed to say I could cover him up, so we're both talking, both of us knowing his penis is exposed and neither of us doing anything about it."

"And Mike's going to come through the door any minute."

"I'm aware of that, too. . . . Now, while he's wide-eyed, knowing I can see his penis, he's explaining how he got hurt. But I can hear the tension in his voice, and I'm thinking maybe I'll just pull up his blanket—it's what I should have done in the first place. I take another look, ready to reach for the blanket, but now his penis is moving. Moving. I'd never seen a flaccid penis large enough to do something like what it was doing. While he's telling me how he was skiing a black diamond trail and lost control on a

jump, the skin on his testicles was clinching and rolling. His penis heaved. . . It heaved like a sleeping man trying to get up off a park bench.”

Colorful. I love it. “He was getting hard?” This is crazy.

Quieter, she says, “His penis was stretching out, the . . . tip doing a nose dive into the sheets.”

“His heart was really pumping.”

She’s far away, describing what she’s seeing in her mind’s eye. “It rolled over on its side as it lifted off the bed and it leaned against the inside of his thigh. Ryan’s face was visibly sweaty—knowing he was getting hard in front of his ex-girlfriend’s mother.”

“Were you still talking, or just watching it?”

“Trying to talk, but it was getting harder. We both knew what was happening. I kept glancing between his legs.”

“He was turned on that you were watching.”

“I didn’t think that when it was happening. It was . . . awful. I was horrified, but stuck to the spot. I should have left, or covered him, instead I just said nothing and watched him get an erection.”

“He got fully hard like that?”

“It lifted off his leg and then with each heartbeat it rose higher. I wanted to see it. Shouldn’t I be ashamed of that?”

“Why?”

“I’m married. Ryan was my daughter’s boyfriend. I knew him when he was a boy.”

“The circumstances are unique, I admit. The moral thing to do was cover him or to leave. But staying isn’t necessarily immoral.”

“That’s what I struggle with. I really couldn’t leave, Hannah. It was like it had just been revealed to me what I was always missing. When I saw what he had, I was transformed; I knew I wanted it. Knew it completely.”

“Tell me what he had.”

She groans like she doesn’t want to, but why else am I here? She knew I was going to ask. Her hand slips to rub the back of her neck. “It was incredible. I don’t know how to describe it. I don’t know how it compares to what you’ve seen . . .”

“Tell me anyway.”

“Huge,” she said, now moving her hands apart to approximate the length of Ryan’s cock. It looks like eight or nine inches. “So straight and so . . . pretty. Or handsome. I don’t know how to—”

“Perfect skin, you said.”

“Right. And the . . . tip, you know—”

“The head.”

“The head was . . . plump and, I don’t know, just so . . . alluring.”

“You can talk to me.”

She chuckles. “Imagine if I said any of this to my therapist? How embarrassing.”

“You sexualize the male anatomy. It’s normal.”

“Normal?”

I say: “Do you think I’m a freak?”

“No.” She sniffs and nods.

“It’s normal,” I say again. “Natural.”

She chuckles enough to rock in her seat. “That’s what I said to Ryan.”

“What did you say?”

“About his erection. At the hospital. It’s the first thing I said. I told him it was natural.”

“It is natural. You think maybe he’d always had a crush on you?”

“He did.”

“He told you that?—wait, just continue. He’s in the hospital bed, he’s got an erection, it’s out for you to see. Go from there.”

“It’s not just me who sees it now. Now he can see it too. He’s embarrassed, and I say to him—”

“It’s natural.”

“Right. . . . So now there’s no ignoring it. It’s upright. Ryan can see it. And I can see it—I’m standing right next to him. Its presence in the room is enormous. Neither of us can say anything, both of us are frozen. This is when I tell him it’s natural.”

“You’re kind.”

“I’m ashamed. But yes, I’m trying to make him feel better. But I also want him to know I’m not offended.”

“You’re the opposite of offended.”

“It’s not like I was flattered, but—”

“You were turned on.”

She’s quiet for a long moment, not looking at me. Then she says, “Yes. You’re right. I was. I was definitely turned on.”

“What does Ryan say then?”

“He apologizes, so I told him again that it’s natural. Nothing to be ashamed of. But then I’m embarrassed to say he shouldn’t be ashamed, as if I’m judging what his emotions are. Like maybe he’s not ashamed, maybe I’m the only one who should be ashamed. I’m not used to being so . . .”

“You were really flustered by him.”

“I guess I was. I’m still . . . I still have this maternal sort of sense for him—no, I shouldn’t say maternal. Caring. Like he’s still that guy who used to hang around our house—God, when he was dating our daughter.” She puts her palm on her forehead. “Anyway, what I did was terrible.”

“Your email said you gave him a hand job.”

She nods. “I . . . I don’t know how it happened. I should have pulled his blanket up, but instead I acted as though his erection should be under his hospital gown. I lift up his hospital gown, now I can see those muscular lines at his hips, his soft bush of pubic hair. . . . And see how flat his stomach is—and I’m trying to get the hospital gown to cover his . . .”

“But he was sitting on it? The hospital gown . . .”

“Right,” she said. “And this is where I touched him.”

“Touched his penis?”

She bites at her upper lip with an even row of bottom teeth. She says, “Yes. I put my hand on him.”

“How did he react?”

“Just drew in a soft inhale and tensed. I told him I was just going to try to put it under his gown. But now it’s in my hand. My heart is pounding out of my chest. I feel this giant sopping ball in my stomach. Below my stomach. It’s this heavy weight . . .”

“Desire.”

She looks up. “Is that what it was?”

“You know that’s what it was.”

She says, “Okay. Desire. All I can hear is my heartbeat in my ears. I’m looking at my hand on him. Admiring the way my hand looks on him. Admiring what he has. The size, the beauty, the sexual masculinity . . .”

I shift in my seat. “Did he tell you to do it?”

“The hand job? No. I try to get the hospital gown to cover, but it’s too big to put it under. I push it to the side, and I guess . . . my hand is stroking on him. Caressing. I’m feeling what he feels like. So hard, so straight. Well, a slight upward curve. . . . But it becomes apparent that I’m enjoying this. And apparent, too, that Ryan’s enjoying it. He’s flexing his thighs, I can see his balls moving around in his sack, tightening up. His . . . cock . . . is throbbing in my hand. And that’s when I start slowly stroking up and down . . .”

“Did he encourage you?”

“Not with words. Not at first. I start pleasing him and I say—no, whisper—maybe I can get it to go down. . . . I can see he’s a little awkward, but that he likes what I’m doing. He’s aroused, but knows how taboo this is. My hand’s moving faster, I’m watching him in my grip, watching the way the skin on his penis moves, and the way his big balls bounce around, and I want him to . . . you know . . .”

“Come.”

“I did. I wanted that. But then, I’m leaning against him, and I can feel that his fingers are moving, so I put my . . . breast where his fingers are and he’s using his fingers—pinching his fingers together to squeeze on my, you know . . .”

“Nipple.”

“Uh-huh. . . . Both of us breathing heavy, and I want it to happen so bad, but all of a sudden I’m out of my body and seeing myself with different eyes. I can picture myself as someone coming in the room. Ryan has a

private room; if you walk in the door, he's the only one you see. Right away. Anyone would see me jerking him off. My scalp starts to tingle, and now I can't think of what I'm doing, all I can do is look to the door. And thank God I did . . ."

"Did somebody come in?"

"I pulled up the blanket. I covered Ryan up, but his erection humped it out so obviously. My hand was still under there, but I figured it would at least give me a chance at avoiding discovery. And I'm saying dirty things, close to him, jerking him off under the blanket. I'm asking him if he's going to come, he saying he's going to, and I tell him I told him I would make it go down. He's pinching my nipple, and I swear to God—"

"You were flooding your panties."

She rolled her eyes, but nodded. "That's not what I was going to say. But I was, indeed. I was going to say that we'd made the room hotter. Both of us breathing and panting, our temperature's going up."

"Go on."

She purses her lips. "Mike came in."

I jolt in my chair. "Are you serious? He saw?"

She shakes her head no. "I whipped my hand out, and I try to act like nothing's going on. Mike comes in all big smiles with his arms out saying, 'Ryan, my boy, what have you done?' I looked down. His penis is covered. I got away with it. I'm standing a foot back from the bed now—but his bulge is so obvious. It's huge. It humps out the bed sheet."

"He didn't come?"

She shook her head no. "He didn't."

"So what happened?"

“That was it. Mike and I talked to him, I’m sure my cheeks were red. But nobody said anything or acted awkward. Ryan was quick to recover. I can see as the conversation goes on that bulge begin to fade; it was going away.”

“Do you think Mike saw?”

She looked straight at me. “You had to be there. You couldn’t miss it.”

“I’ll bet. So that was it? That was all that happened? . . .”

Despite the lack of closure on Kristy's story, it affected me. Tightened my stomach. The salaciousness was wild, and she didn't see the value in that. Just thought I wanted lurid details from start to finish: hand job to full and complete big dick sex. But she'd given up a lot that day in the hospital room, risked an enormous amount. Anyone could've walked in that room: a doctor, nurse, some other of Ryan's family, her husband . . .

Yet, the fact there was more to be told had my heart racing.

"Wait," I say, remembering now there must be more than the hand job.

"You met with him . . ."

She nods, puts her hands back in her lap. "Right here in this room," she says, looking around us.

I might be now sitting right where Ryan sat. I take another sip of my drink, weave my fingers together. "You met him here in New York?"

"He goes to school at NYU. I arranged to meet him here."

"You called him?"

She shakes her head no. "We've been talking for a little while on Facebook. And he had me install Snapchat."

I clear my throat, trying to imagine all the things that have could that could have transpired between them in that time. "For how long?"

"A few months now."

"So tell me what happened. I really want to hear it."

“It’s wild,” she said. “If I just had that simple hospital story, I feel like I wouldn’t have met with you. But now . . .”

“Tell me your sins, that’s what I’m here for.”

She chuckles at this, then crosses one leg over the other, content with my answer. “It is what I’m here for. . . . Okay,” she said, “this is weird.”

“Weirder than what happened in Boulder?”

“Much weirder,” she said. “After what I did, I was ashamed, bottomlessly guilty. I even went into a depression for a spell. Mike—he’s such a great guy—he was always there, trying to cheer me up. But I didn’t want to be cheered up. I wanted to be punished.”

“You don’t deserve to be punished.”

She ignores my comment, continuing: “One morning . . .” She trails off, thinking about it, eyes focused far away. “He’s trying to get me to laugh. I was having a better morning, and he figured he might be able to do it. If I told him to stop, he’d stop. But that morning, he put his hands on me . . . but he was trying to tickle me. I didn’t tell him to stop. I wanted to be held. Then he says . . .”

There’s a long beat of silence and I say, “Says what?”

“He’s tickling me, the mood is high and funny, and he says, ‘Hey, did you see that hump under Ryan’s blanket—what the heck was that?’ So my first inclination is to deny it, act shocked. It’s almost like an accusation, only he’s in such a good mood, and he’s being so good to me . . .”

“How long was this after Boulder?”

“Two weeks. Ryan had come back home to our town to stay with his parents for another week before he went back to school—I was so afraid of running into him.”

“Is this when he contacted you?”

“Don’t skip ahead,” she said. “This is important.”

“It is, I know, sorry.”

“I say to Mike, ‘What blanket?’ and he keeps egging me on, saying ‘The hospital blanket.’ I’m still playing dumb, going, ‘I don’t remember a blanket,’ and asking him what he’s talking about. He’s persistent, tickling me, and he is getting to me. You don’t understand, no one ever gets to me. Not even Mike.”

I think to myself that Mike probably knows his place.

She bites her lower lip for a second, eyes turned down. “He gets me laughing, saying, ‘I know exactly what he’s talking about.’ And I’m saying I don’t. He keeps tickling, saying, ‘You know exactly what I’m talking about, I know you saw.’ I try to be angry for a moment, squirming away and grabbing his arms. I’m close to putting an end to the whole thing, but I blurt out: ‘I don’t know what you’re talking about,’ and then explode in laughter. It’s like this huge release. Like I’d popped this balloon filled with all this awful tension. And Mike’s playing with me, not tickling now, like stroking me. Laughing and saying, ‘I know you saw.’ And being playful like that changed everything. I felt so much better, and I felt so close to Mike. This is so clichéd, but we hadn’t been playful and fun like that, maybe since we were in our twenties.”

“He made you feel better.”

“For a little while it worked. Listen, that’s not the thing. He’s still playing around with me, and I’m letting him. Then he starts kissing me, and I can feel that he’s hard.”

“Oh,” I say.

“I’d prefer to keep the details of my husband and I a little more private, but I’ll say that we made love very well that morning. Twice. Both of us were turned on.”

“And he started it.”

She nods. “That got me out of bed. That got me back to work again and feeling a lot better. I wouldn’t tell him what I did, but somehow acknowledging it in a small way with someone else made me feel better. I’d already sent you the email at that point. Before Mike had acknowledged it with me.”

“I’ve emailed with you since then.”

“You have.”

“When did Ryan reach out to you?”

“I guess he waited till he was healed. I talked to his mother a few times, and she said he was doing well—I needed a drink that night—but then Ryan contacted me on Facebook. It was months later. We were already friends, I’m not often on there, but I get this message from him. It’s nice, polite. He says he’s doing much better now and then tells me how much he appreciated my visit. My visit. Appreciated it. I know I have to be careful, I’m an older woman who might be vulnerable to the charms of a young man like Ryan, so I’m tepid. In the back of my head, though, I’m thinking there was something implied there. He didn’t mention Mike. Only mentioned me, said he appreciated it.”

“Like he appreciated what you did.”

“Right. Then he replies back to my reply, again with this sort of insinuation. But this time I’m playful in return. Next time he sends me a message, he’s saying how he wishes he wasn’t in that hospital bed. Wishes we had more time. And I fall for it. I am completely into it.”

I say, “What else would you do?”

“He sends me another message telling me what he would do to me. It’s hot. I’m so worried, I’m so upset that I’m going to be made fun of. That it’s him and his college buddies are they’re all in on this together, all of them laughing at me . . .”

“It wouldn’t be impossible. But . . . you’re really beautiful. I’d be strongly inclined to think it wasn’t.”

“It wasn’t. We talked a lot more. Not on Facebook anymore, on the phone. . . . The idea, you understand, that this unbelievably handsome young man would be interested in me is dangerous. And despite what I did in the hospital, I know that I wouldn’t do any more. I already knew that it had been a mistake. What happened was a mistake. I suffered. And because I never told Mike what happened, it was still stuck in me. And that sliver reminded me not to do that again. The depression starts all over. I know at this point that I can’t go any farther with Ryan. I want to, but what was happening between us was sparked by what I did and that should never happen again. I go back into this low. This time when Mike tries to cheer me up, I confess. I play it down, but I tell him in the hospital Ryan’s gown had come up and that his penis was exposed. I tell him Ryan had been sleeping, and I tried to pull down his gown to cover it, but that’s when he began to get an erection. I leave it at that, that’s enough. I tell Mike I’m the one who put the blanket over it.”

“How did he react?”

“He . . . ravished me. Way more intense than that first time I told you about. We . . . went all night. In one of the breaks, I told him that Ryan had been contacting me. That he’d been . . . coming on to me.”

“You’re saying Mike liked it?”

“Mikey liked it,” she said and laughed. When she didn’t get a response, she looked at me said, “Old commercial.”

“I know. I didn’t laugh because I’m flabbergasted.”

“Mike wants to read the messages. The most salacious things weren’t on the phone, but some things we texted were a little risqué, and I still had those. I couldn’t believe I was showing my husband. But Mike . . . Mike was committed. He was being honest.”

“So he read Ryan’s messages to you?”

“And my moderately flirty responses. It excited him. Really excited him. We kept making love that night, and he would say dirty things to me.”

“Like what?” I say after clearing my throat.

“Telling me how hot I was, and . . . you don’t— He’s never said anything like that. Not for a long time, really. But . . . he was telling me how cruel I was to Ryan, how I teased him. It was wild. Again,” she said, her eyebrows going high, “we made love all night. Not a joke. Till the sun came up. But then that next day, I fell back into it.”

“It?”

“Malaise. . . . We didn’t talk about what happened that night. Our dirty talk. Mike was definitely chipper,” she said and almost laughed. “But he didn’t bring it up, either. A week later, we’re messing around, and when we make love, he does that dirty talk again. So now, Hannah,” she says, putting both hands up to indicate this was important, “Mike and I enter an unprecedented phase in our marriage. We’re having sex every day. Ryan is seeping into our love life. He’s part of our dirty talk. Mike’s telling me to talk to him. Call him. Again,” she said, “I don’t want to illuminate my love life with my husband, but I have to tell you this: one night I called Ryan. I was in bed, Mike was with me. While I talked to Ryan, Mike listened in and he . . .” She makes a funny face like she can’t continue.

I can guess. “Really?”

She nods. “Pleased me.”

“Orally?”

She puffs air and rolls her eyes, pushing back in her chair like she’s uncomfortable. That was a yes.

A string tightened somewhere down below my stomach, and it had me crossing my own legs. I was pretty sure where this was going, and I couldn’t believe it. “Are you saying he encouraged you?”

She nods again. “I know it’s a thing now. I looked it up.”

“It’s never too late to learn how to google dirty things.”

She smiles. “You’re right. So now all the things I want to do with Ryan, I’m considering them. Considering in a way that would please Mike. Now Mike is my focus.”

“Oh my God,” I say, completely by accident, following up with: “That’s so hot.” I sound like a dorky teenager. I cover my mouth and hope she didn’t hear that.

“It is so hot,” she says. “But it’s done now. It’s done now, and I’m afraid to go home.”

I’m alarmed. “Wait—what’s done?”

Kristy looks to the left as if she's in a different time-space, saying, "Three nights ago, like I said. Here in this room with Ryan."

"And Mike knows?"

She nods. "Mike's at home. But Mike definitely knows."

"He was in on it."

"He made it happen. Told me to do it. One night he even begged me to have an affair with Ryan. I told him no. . . . You know, deep down," she says, frowning, "I always knew I would give in, I just wanted to make him beg me to do it."

"He begged you?"

"I had him begging."

I'd only known her for an hour, but I could see how quickly she would fall into that dominant role. I was excited by the prospect of this story. "How did it happen?"

"I arranged to meet him here in the city. He wanted to go out for dinner, but I didn't want to be seen with him. I told him to meet me at my hotel room here at ten o'clock."

"So that made it clear what it was about."

"Not just by the time of night I suggested, we told each other what we would do when we met." She rubs at her neck. "He shows up at ten. First thing that surprises me is how tall he is. He was never short, but in the last three years he'd really become a man. When I'd seen him in the hospital he

was laying down—but when I answer the door, he was a head above me. Strange, honestly, it instantly changed the dynamic between us. Maybe it was always going to be changed, but that’s when it started.”

“What started?”

“The way I changed.”

“Tell me how you changed.”

“I invite him in, I make the ruse that we’re going to have drinks together first; we go to the bar,” she says, eyes tracking to the bar from where she served me. “My hands are on the bottles, but Ryan’s behind me. He’s got his hands on me now, rubbing all over my front. He touches my breasts and my knees went loose. . . . I slumped against him and he put his hand under my skirt, ran it up my thigh. Touched me where no one had touched me but Mike for twenty-three years.”

“And it was Ryan,” I say.

Her eyes widened. “It was Ryan. . . . He puts his hand inside my panties, puts a finger inside me. We can both hear . . . well, you know . . .”

“How wet you are.”

She makes a face, but agrees. “Yes. I’m breathing so heavy . . . I pictured this going a whole different way. One where I would be in control. Where I call the shots. I’d worn new lingerie. Planned to seduce him. Tell him what I wanted. By showing him my body. I’ve been exercising.”

“In anticipation.”

“Right. But when I answered the door, it was a different Ryan. He wasn’t my daughter’s ex-boyfriend anymore. He wasn’t that high school kid hanging around my house. He wasn’t wearing a sweatshirt and a ball cap—he was a man now. He dressed like a man. Whatever he was doing to me, I’d never felt that way before.”

“You didn’t have control.”

“He had control. And he pulls me over to where you’re sitting there.”

“Yeah?” I say, having trouble swallowing.

“And he sits down on the couch, and I . . .”

“You what?”

“I went on my knees for him. I’ve never gone on my knees, ever. But I got down on my knees in front of that couch, and my hands were stroking his thighs, then grabbing his bulge . . .”

I can see her cheeks reddened. I know mine are reddening as well.

Her voice reduces to a whisper. “I tell him to take it out. I tell him I want to see it. And then I sit there. Not me. I’m someone else. I’m sitting patient on my knees between his legs, I’m watching his hands work the zipper down. And then when he pulls it out, literally, Hannah, my eyes flutter.” She shakes her head, disbelieving the way she changed for Ryan.

“You thought you were going to be the one in charge.”

“But I wasn’t. I hadn’t seen it coming. I really pictured it so differently. . . . Then, when he’s got it out, I just want to . . .”

“Be submissive?”

“That’s it. I really want to be honest here.”

“I told you you can confess to me.”

“I wanted to submit to him. He could have done anything to me. I wouldn’t have stopped him. I even told him . . . Don’t judge me . . .”

“There’re no judgments here, Kristy. I told you that.”

“I told him,” she puts her hands up to her face and pats her cheeks, looks up at the chandelier on the high ceiling. “Told him I wanted to worship it.”

So incredibly hot, but I don't want to interrupt her story. I could feel the room heating up the way she said it was with her and Ryan at the hospital. Both of us are taking long, deep breaths.

"And I do worship it. I get up, elbows on the couch seat, between his legs, and I worship . . . worship . . ."

"His huge cock."

She snuffles. "His huge cock."

When she's quiet too long, I say, "With your mouth?"

She nods. "I was never into that. I'd done it once or twice, but it's not something that interested me. But all I wanted to do was please him. Wanted him to"—she looked up at me now—"wanted him to pull my hair, be rough with me."

"Fuck your mouth."

She turns her nose up in disgust, but says, "He did. I told you I would've let him do anything."

"But you wanted it."

"I did."

"And then?"

"He puts his hands under my armpits, lifts me up, stands with me. He undresses me, turns me around. He . . . spanked my bottom."

"While you were standing there?"

"Yeah. Spanked my ass, and I let him. This is a young . . . he played video games in my house, Hannah."

"But now he's a man."

“A man. Tall. Handsome. He’s still wearing a suit. No tie, just a shirt with a collar. And his fly is down, and his . . . his . . .”

“Huge cock.”

“Huge cock is sticking out. And I’m standing there with my arms down, my palms go back like I want to stop him from spanking me, but I don’t stop him. I want him to do it. He bends me over, pushes my face into the corner of the couch and he . . . he puts a knee down, gets low and does . . . terrible things.”

“With his tongue?”

“Yes. But maybe not where you’re thinking.”

“Wow. Your ass—are you kidding?”

“So that’s pretty crazy?”

“To be honest, Kristy, it’s incredible. Not crazy at all, like, literally, you have hit the jackpot here.”

“But he dated my daughter.”

I don’t know if it’s shame, or that it’s this haunting thought that the things Ryan did with her he may have done with her daughter. I don’t pursue it. It’s not relevant to the case.

“It’s different now,” I say. “They’re at different schools, both of them moved on. He’s a man now. He’s twenty-one, for crying out loud.”

She’s still sucking her lower lip, not talking.

I say, “But maybe that’s part of the hotness.” Meaning how taboo and terrible her partner selection is.

She nods, but just ever so slightly. “He . . . I . . .”

I look to the left and picture Kristy's face shoved into this couch seat right next to me. Right where my face is hovering now would be where Ryan's tongue was pleasuring Kristy's anus. It's so wild I can't believe it. Far hotter than what I thought I would discover in this meeting. It's got me shifting in my seat, feeling sweaty and uncomfortable.

Kristy says, "You're not going to finish my sentence for me this time?"

I'd been preoccupied with thoughts of analingus. I say, "I want you to say it."

She groans, swipes her hair back from her face with both hands and holds it at her ears. She says, "Orgasmed."

From his tongue up her ass? "I hope you know how incredibly lucky you are."

"Do you really mean that?" she says, looking up at me.

"You've got everything you wanted."

"I do," she said. "I guess."

"There's nothing to be ashamed about. You said Mike begged you to do it."

"He did. . . . But I wanted to do it before it ever happened."

"Maybe he's always known that, and that's part of why he wants it to happen, too. He loves you, right?"

"Oh, I don't worry about that at all. Mike is honest and faithful . . . he's the best man. He really is."

"So then just tell me what happened next. And don't hold back."

She shakes her head, puts her hands on her knees and rubs them in circles for a second. "I have to say, what he did to me on the couch there, it had quite an effect. He left me . . . quivering. And he just, just . . . He scooped me up. Carried me in the lingerie I was wearing—lingerie I wore to control

him. I've been working out, I'm toned, fit, I pictured Ryan wilting once I took off my clothes."

"He didn't wilt."

"I wilted. I was the one who wilted. I was a sopping mess in his arms. Half conscious. Seriously. Next thing I know, I'm in the bed, and I'm thinking I want him to tie me up. I tell him to. I tell him to tie me up. He takes off his suit, shirt. He's naked. Erect. His penis is wagging over my body; he uses his dress shirt to tie my hands together and then hooks them on this decorative loop carved in the headboard. My hands are up above my head, and I've got this naked twenty-one-year-old Greek God, Hannah, I'm not kidding, getting on his elbows and knees between my thighs. I hook my ankles around the back of his neck, and then he does that thing again. But this time where you'd expect it. Makes me come again. By the time he's up and kissing me, I could be anywhere. I'm out of my mind. I feel him . . . his cock . . . pushing against me. I'm so . . . wet . . . that even though it's so big, he's able to get it in me. I brought lube in preparation. But all those things he did to me made it unnecessary."

Kristy goes quiet for too long. The room is silent and our deep breathing sounds too loud. When I sit forward, I can feel my shirt sticking to my back.

Kristy rubs her knees again, saying, "I need another drink. Can I fix you another?"

*Now? She rises and moves to the bar. I say no, but then change my mind.
"Yes, please. Lots of ice."*

Kristy uses two new glasses, setting them on the countertop of the small bar, then she moves aside, slipping behind a Queen Anne chair to stoop and open a window. The window of her suite is a springline style, eight feet tall with a circular top, but underneath there are four small square windowpanes and she levers one open. Cool air chills on my shins and now the sounds of traffic buffer our heavy breathing. She returns to the bar, and I stand and walk to join her. She hands me more whiskey in the glass, lots of ice, and I move behind the Queen Anne chair to cool off. She joins me with her drink, both of us standing about a foot apart now, the open window between us at our knees. She leans her back on the wall next to the window and slowly slides downward, resting her elbows on her knees, leaning her head back against the wall. I pull over a low leather padded Ottoman with cat's claw feet and sit opposite her. The cold air feels nice.

"Hannah," Kristy says, "I know you've been with men who were well-endowed."

"I have."

"I've never before."

"I know. It's different . . ."

"It is," she said and sipped her drink, looking past me to where we'd been sitting. "Different. . . . I don't know how to describe it," she said, "but it was like . . . being owned. It wasn't a union like I'd felt before. Because Ryan was so large, and also, apparently, I'm so turned on by that, that all my attention was on his entry. I . . . bit his neck. All I could . . . Every sense I had was at full attention on . . ."

"On him stretching you."

“Stretching. It’s . . . You’re right. His size dominated me. Claimed every bit of me. My attention. My body . . . My heart rate . . . I was flooding. Flooding to accept him.”

“It can take some getting use to.”

“As soon as he pushed it into me—not even all the way—I knew this was what I’ve been missing. This was what I wanted to feel. This to me was sex. But it’s not my . . .”

“Husband. But Ryan’s his proxy.”

“You think so?”

“I think so.”

Kristy said, “Well, at this point I’m not thinking of Mike. My mind is on fire. I can’t believe how it feels.” She’s running her nails on her upper arms. She sips from her drink again and continues. “Stretching, yes, and so . . . deep. And I’ve got my hands above me, I’m pinned underneath him, I’m biting on his neck, and he starts, you know . . .”

“Fucking you.”

“Fucking me, but he’s doing it like I’ve never had it before. Not timid, not sharing like we’re lovers or anything, he’s just physical. It’s all physical. Physical domination.”

Now I take a sip of my drink, pull an ice cube into my mouth and roll it around before slipping it back into the glass. “This is an incredible story,” I say.

“I guess it is,” she says.

“I don’t understand how you could see it any other way.”

“I’m getting used to it.”

“It might take time for you to get it, but I really do think you’re a lucky woman.”

“You ever hear of a husband who wants this?”

“Yes. I have. I’ve read about it, and I’ve talked to a few people who engage. I’ve never met someone who just wandered into it unknowingly. The people I’ve talked to are fully in the lifestyle.”

“It’s a lifestyle?”

“It can be. It doesn’t have to be. Maybe you’ll do it just one time.”

Kristy is considering it a moment, sips her drink, puts it down between her ankles.

I say, “Go on.”

“Well, Ryan’s fucking me. Like I said, it’s not how it’s ever been done before. It’s being done to me. He’s toying with me. He’s fucking hard and fast and then slowing down. Biting on my neck . . . I couldn’t believe how sex could be.”

“And it didn’t hurt?”

“It didn’t hurt. I suppose maybe a little at first, but . . .”

“You were wet.”

“I was. . . . When he stops, he’s in control because I want it so bad. And he knows he’s in control.”

“And you gave up your control.”

“It was taken from me.”

“You don’t ever surrender control?”

She looks my way, trying to see if I’m making fun of her. I’m not.

She says, “I don’t like it.”

“You liked it when Ryan took control.”

She doesn’t want to admit it, but quietly she says, “Yes.”

“And you don’t think you’re lucky?”

“Do you know how scary it is to give up control?”

“That’s why I say you’re lucky. You’re not giving up control. You’re surrendering to yourself. You’re playing at surrendering control to someone else.”

“It felt scary. Like you’re on something runaway, and you don’t know how to steer it.”

“That’s the thrill. . . . Tell me it wasn’t thrilling.”

She rubs at her neck, and in the light from the street below I can see blue cast on her angular cheekbone and jaw. She’s blushing again. “Do you think I like submitting?”

“You’re always in control, day-to-day, but there’s one way you don’t want that anymore. I say you’re lucky because you have a husband that trusts you and is willing to explore.”

“You’re not saying you think Mike knows—”

“That Ryan would take control? No. . . . But he knows there’s something you need. Thank God he can find something in it for himself.”

“I don’t need Ryan.”

“You need that loss of control. That domination. You never fantasized about someone having power over you?”

“That’s a fantasy?”

“Sure. So many have it.”

“That’s crazy.”

“So you’ve never thought of it?”

She shrugs and lifts up her glass. I’m pretty sure she’s thought of it.

“So tell me what happened.”

She continues: “I’m not even thinking of Ryan as Ryan anymore. It’s dark and I can’t really see him. I can feel his body against mine. Feel how strong he is. How young and supple his skin is. He’s tall and lean and strong. I feel so different under him than any other man before. But it’s not him I’m thinking of.”

“It’s a dark fantasy.”

“He makes me . . . orgasm. A lot. So many times, Hannah. More than I’ve ever . . .”

“It’s incredible.”

“It was. He had complete control of me. Every time he moved that thing inside me, my legs were shaking. Then, seriously, I’ve lost track of time. It was almost an hour. It had to be. He pulls it out . . .”

“And?”

“and I watched him, you know, play with it. Jerk it. And he . . .”

“He ejaculates.”

“Yes, he ejaculates . . .”

“All over you.”

She nods. “All over me. And I’m squirming underneath him. The idea that I would allow someone to do that’s so alien to me. It’s disgusting. But when

he comes on me—I can't even believe it—I come again.”

Despite sitting low and close to the open window, I can feel the hot flush again. The backs of my arms are burning and my upper lip feels moist. More whiskey, more ice. “And this was three days ago?”

She says, “It wasn't over.”

“Okay.”

“Ryan takes a pillowcase and uses it to tie the shirt that's looped around my wrists tighter onto the headboard. Now I really can't get free. And he gets up, stands at the side of the bed and admires me. Touching my face, thumbing my mouth open and making me suck—oh God—his thumb.”

“And he's only twenty-one?”

“He's got me heaving and panting on the bed. I came so many times, but all I want is to go again. He bends down and kisses me. Right on the lips. We hadn't done that yet. It's so strange for him to be suddenly tender. Then he says, ‘Wait for me.’ I ask him what that means, and he stands up and says, ‘Wait for me.’ And then he goes to leave and I say, ‘How long?’ He doesn't answer, just closes the door, leaving me tied to the bed with his semen on my stomach and my chest.”

“This is crazy.”

“Okay, so now you're seeing it?”

“Crazy in the best way possible,” I say, rubbing the back of my neck.

“I don't know how long I was there, but it had to be half an hour. Maybe more. I'm in agony. My shoulders are sore, my stomach is all in knots and butterflies at the same time. I know that if I tried, I could get free—but I don't want to ruin it. I don't want Ryan to be . . . upset at me. I have no idea how long he wants me to wait, and just when I feel like I'm going to go crazy, he comes back in. He has the lube from my purse. He went through my purse. I feel violated and mad, but I don't even say anything. Hannah,

he went through my purse. My personal belongings . . . but all I care about is he's returned. I know that if he has the lube, he wants more. And I want more. He gets over me, straddling me. His cock is half-hard. So huge still. Laying on my stomach. I can feel the weight of it. But he's taking too long. When he sees how much I want him, now he has me. . . . Hannah, he made me beg. He made me beg."

"And you begged?"

"I begged for him. It felt incredible to beg."

"Wow," I say, taking the ice cube in my mouth again.

"He makes me beg, and when he decides that he's going to give me what I'm asking for, he does it in the way he wants. Not the way I want. He gets me to turn over, putting a hand on the small of my back and rolling me so that I'm face down in the pillows. He pulls on my hips to bring my ass up —"

"Unbelievable . . ."

"Yeah. He puts lube on himself, and all around, you know . . ."

"Your anus."

"And then—though I've never had anal sex in my entire life—he pushes inside me and I accept it. The intrusion is enormous. I can't believe how sexual something so dirty feels. He holds my ass with his two huge hands and fucks me from behind like that. My face in the pillow, my ass turned up, spanking me and slapping me on my ass and my thighs. I came from that. There has to be something wrong with me . . ." Now she rubs her cheeks and takes a moment to cover her face.

"There's nothing to be ashamed of. This is the best scenario you can imagine."

"I feel guilty for wanting it."

"It'll go away."

“In a way, I hope it doesn’t.”

“Because . . . you like the guilt, and . . . you want him again?”

She chewed at her cheek but doesn’t nod—I can see that the answer she’s afraid to say is yes.

She says, “After he does that, fucks my, you know, ass, he rolls me over again, onto my side now, and he takes me like that. And then it’s kind of all hazy after that. . . . Have you ever had that?”

“Being fucked into oblivion?”

“That’s what you call it?”

“Not officially. But yes, I’ve had that.”

“It’s normal?”

“It’s the pinnacle. It’s what you strive for.”

“I don’t know what to say. Don’t know what to think. Been in this room for three days.”

“What do you want to hear from me?”

“I didn’t think I needed to hear anything from you, but I think what you said makes me feel better.”

“You really worry about that? Think you’re a freak or something?”

“This is a lot for me to get used to.”

“So what happened next?”

“Like I said, it was hazy. He fucked me on my side, then from behind again. Not in my ass, but just from behind. Then I was on top of him. I didn’t have as many orgasms after that, but they did still keep coming. I completely lost count. I don’t remember what happened. I think I passed out. In the

morning I wake up and I'm by myself. I'm in the bed. He's untied me, covered me in blankets, it looks like he's dried me off with a towel. There's a towel by the side of the bed. But I'm naked. He's not in the room, he's not in the apartment. I come out to find my purse upside down on the coffee table. My things gone through. There's a glass and a bottle of whiskey by the chair over there," she says as she nods to the other side of the room. "So when he tied me up he just came out here and drank whiskey, watched TV or something. Leaving me tied up and writhing. Wanting him back. Knowing he was driving me crazy. . . . How does somebody like him become so confident?"

"That big dick."

She laughs, and her laugh keeps rolling until it becomes low breathy chuckles. She holds up her glass and takes another drink of whiskey, swallows, says, "That big dick."

"So it was all you ever hoped it to be?"

"More. I didn't know what to hope for. Didn't know what to expect. It went completely sideways on me and—"

"You loved every minute of it."

"Not every minute. And not always love. Sometimes fear and panic and anxiety and this unbelievably strange kind of lust."

"God, I can't imagine if you had reneged on me."

She looks my way. "You mean not told you my story?"

"I wouldn't know what I missed, but now that I know I'm so glad to have heard it—I would hate not to have heard it."

She stays looking at me, I see that she's smiling. It's weird to see her smile, and though it doesn't seem natural, the smile does look very good on her. But the smile slowly fades.

I say, "What?"

“Mike.”

“What about him?”

“I have to go home.”

“You told him what happened?”

She shakes her head no, then says, “Well, I told him it was done.”

“And you didn’t tell him any more?”

“No, I didn’t. I was afraid to. Afraid to talk about it. He keeps texting me, wanting to know I’m okay. I tell him I’m fine and I’m going to stay a few more days.”

“You’re driving him absolutely crazy.”

She half smiles. “I know.”

“You’re doing it on purpose?”

“Not at first. But I love hearing him suffer.”

“You’re sick.”

She darts me a quick glance, then eases when she sees I’m joking. “Mike’s hurting in a way that he likes. I know that he’s hard as a rock at home.”

“And if you don’t tell him what happened, he’s making up stories in his head.”

“I know he likes it. . . . I think he likes it.”

“I think he likes it, too.”

“You think so? You can see that?”

“I can.”

She looks at me hopefully. “Hannah, then . . . then maybe you could help me . . .”

I watch Kristy's well-manicured fingers bring awake her phone and tap the contact she sought to dial. We've moved away from the cool of the window, and we're sitting side-by-side on the couch like two teenagers about to make a prank call. I can't believe what I'm doing. Yet I'm somehow thoroughly engaged. My heart's racing. Both of us have finished our drinks, and I think the warmth of the whiskey is giving me confidence.

Kristy removes an earring, sets it down on the table in front of us, flicks away her hair and puts her phone to her ear. I'm wringing my hands together.

"Hi," she says. I can hear a voice on the other end. A male voice. Mike, I presume.

Kristy says, "I'm fine. How are you doing? . . . That's too bad. . . . No, I know . . . I'm fine . . . I'm doing very fine. . . . Yes. . . . Soon. . . . Maybe tomorrow or the next day. . . . I know . . ." She chuckles and looks my way. She gives me an expression like things are going well. She says to Mike, "I will tell you. . . . No, nothing bad . . . It was good. . . . I'm not mad at you at all, Mike. . . . I love you, too. . . . It was. . . . No, I really did . . . I have . . . Hold on, Mike, I have someone who wants to talk to you. . . . What? . . . Not Ryan. . . . Hold on . . ."

She takes the phone from her ear, a small devilish smile pulled to one side. She passes me the phone, and I take it, looking at her for a moment before I put it to my ear. She urges me to continue. This was her idea. And I'm not timid. I'm going to be very good at this game. My heart isn't racing from trepidation, it's excitement. I put the phone to my ear and say hello.

"Hi. Who's this?"

“Hi, Mike,” I say, getting my voice low and breathy and feminine. “Call me Scarlett.” Kristy smiles wider.

“Scarlett? And . . . who are you?”

“Kristy’s New York friend. We got together tonight to have a few drinks.”

“You’re a friend of hers?”

I move around his line of questioning. “Kristy was telling me about Ryan.”

There’s a long dreadful silence, and I enjoy it. I smile at Kristy and she smiles back. Two mean girls working in unison. I say, “Mike? You there?”

“Yeah,” he croaks.

“You know who Ryan is, right?”

“What did she tell you?”

“About Ryan? Everything, I guess. Is there more you want to tell me?”

“No. . . . What’s going on?”

“You wanted something and your wife gave it to you.”

“What did I want?”

“I told you she told me it all. Everything. You depraved man.”

“Is this a joke?”

“What would be funny about it, Mike?”

“Is Kristy okay? I mean, is she really okay?”

“She’s all right now.”

“She wasn’t all right?”

“I think she stayed in bed the whole next day.”

“What whole next day?”

“After she fucked Ryan.” I can feel the psychic pain across thousands of miles on this thin telecommunications string. Somewhere wherever Mike and Kristy actually live, Mike probably just had to sit down. And if he was already sitting down, he might be lying on the floor. “You there?”

“What’s going on? Who are you?”

“Kristy’s a little shy right now. A little overwhelmed by all the things she did with Ryan. But she hates leaving you in the dark for too long. She said I could tell you whatever you want to know.”

“Is this a game?”

“Well it’s not very game like if there’s no chance you’re going to win.”

“I’m not going to win?”

“It’s not a game, but we are playing.”

“But who are you?”

“I told you I’m Kristy’s Manhattan friend. Sometimes we get together for drinks when she’s here. This time when we got together, she sure had a story to tell me. Don’t you want to know what happened?”

There’s a long moment where Mike says nothing, but I can hear his phone brushing against his cheek as he moves to somewhere more comfortable, I imagine. He asks: “What happened?”

“Kristy said you encouraged her to have an affair.”

“Not really . . .”

“Mike, be honest. Kristy was honest with me.”

“But I don’t know you.”

“Kristy knows me. Do you trust Kristy?”

Another long silence. “I do.”

“I think it’s hot, Mike. Don’t worry. I think what you wanted her to do was about the hottest thing I’ve ever heard.”

“Do you really?”

“Of course. And then the things she told me Ryan did to her”—I draw in a long intake of air, trying to build up the suspense.

“Did to her? What did he do to her?”

“He pounded the shit out of her, Mike. She came on his huge cock so many times she passed out.”

Mike drones a soft masculine groan.

I say, “That was quite the gift you gave to your wife.”

“She enjoyed it?”

“I told you, Mike, she came on his cock so many times she lost count. Ryan knows how to fuck. The things she told me . . .”

“Like what?”

“You know he bent her over and spanked her? Spanked her and then ate her asshole.”

“Good Lord,” Mike groaned.

“Can you believe it? How hot is that? You know how Kristy is—she thought she was going to be in charge. The second this hot young man walks into her hotel room, she’s literally on her knees worshipping his giant cock.”

Softly: “Giant?”

“Kristy says you saw it.”

“I didn’t see it.”

“Under the blanket, Mike.”

He sighs. “Right.”

“From what Kristy told me, I’m going to guess Ryan’s cock was about nine inches long. Do you know what that feels like?”

“How would I?”

“I’ve had that before. I know how Kristy feels. Know why she would get on her knees and worship it.”

“You’re toying with me.”

“You don’t want to be toyed with?”

“I . . . I want to know more.”

“Ryan tied her up. Can you believe it? This young man tied your wife’s hands to the headboard and fucked for an hour until she couldn’t remember her own name.”

Mike, wherever he is, is dying a horrible death. He’s not groaning, but I can hear sounds in his throat of the torment he suffers. But I also know that there’s a fun and wacky part of his brain that is riding a roller coaster right now. Mike says, “For an hour?”

“Then he pulled that monster out and came all over her tits.”

“Jesus . . . shit . . .” It sounds like he pounded his knee with his fist.

“Yeah. Came all over her, then left her tied up for like an hour. She was moaning his name, wanting him to come back and fuck her again, but he

made her wait.”

“That’s not Kristy.”

“Not the Kristy you know, but I guess you don’t have what it takes to turn your wife into a dripping, panting little sex kitten.”

“This is for real?”

“One-hundred percent for real. Right now I’m sitting in the spot where Ryan put his tongue right up her asshole and made her come.”

“Fuck,” he sighs. “Who are you?”

“Call me Scarlett.”

“Scarlett who?”

I ignore his question; I’m the one in control. “When he finally comes back Mike, your wife’s begging for him. Begging for him to fuck her again. And he does. Put her knees up to her ears and pounds her pussy six ways from Sunday. Flips her over and fucks her like a dog. She’s crying his name. Begging for him to go deeper and harder and he gives it to her, Mike. Gives it to her until the orgasms are coming out of her like beads pulled on a string. One after the other, the pleasure rolling through her until she passes out.”

“Passes out? Was she okay?”

“I’d say she was more than okay. He left her worn out and exhausted, but he tucked his ex-girlfriend’s mom under the covers, let her sleep in. She didn’t wake up till about eleven in the morning. That sound like the Kristy you know?”

“Not at all.”

“Guess she’s never been fucked like that before, huh?”

“No . . .”

“You’re a champ, Mike. A man above men. I hope you got something out of it.”

“I don’t know . . . Can I talk to Kristy?”

My eyes dart Kristy’s way. I’m getting into this way more than I even thought I would. I say to him, “Tell me something . . .”

“What?”

“You hard as a rock right now?”

Kristy grimaces hearing my vulgar and personal question asked of her husband, but the grimace eases into another smile.

Mike says, “No.”

“Are you sure?”

Another long silence. “No.”

“I think you’re rock hard right now thinking of the woman you love being folded up and manhandled, tied up and pounded by a young man with a huge cock. Hey, Mike . . .?”

He croaks, “What?”

“Ryan came inside her that second time. You know that?”

“He did?”

“Came inside her. Deep inside her.”

“Oh my God . . .”

“He fucked her ass, too. And your Kristy loved it . . .”

His groan fades as the phone moves farther from his face. I picture him sprawled out somewhere. Wanting so badly to connect with his wife right

now—but Kristy is torturing him. Drawing out his awful pleasure. Taking a wonderful taffy treat and warming it, stretching it, making it last. It’s incredible how quickly she’s caught on. But then, she seems like someone who is already a master of controlling others. She nods to me and I pass back her phone. She puts her ear to it and says, “Mike . . .?” Her eyes flick to me.

“I think he passed out,” I say.

Kristy smiles and hunches forward. A little louder now, she says, “Mike . . .?”

I say, “It was too much for him.”

At last, she has her husband on the line again. “Did you hear all that? . . . Good. . . . No, that’s all you get to hear . . . I’ll be home in a few days. . . . I’m not coming home tomorrow. . . . Would you beg me to? . . . I’d have to change my flight. . . . You know how I hate that. . . . You do it for me. . . . I will. If you make the arrangements, I’ll come home tomorrow. . . . No, I said, that’s all you get to hear tonight . . . I’m fine, Mike . . . Make my plans for me. If you’re good, I’ll see you tomorrow. . . . I love you . . . You, too. Bye, now.” She closes off the call and sits back a moment to enjoy her victory.

“That was pretty hot,” I say.

“You were excellent,” she says. “Better than I could’ve hoped.”

“I think it worked.”

“I knew it would,” she says. “I’m driving him wild.”

“Are you going to go home tomorrow?”

“Of course,” she says, sitting forward and putting her phone on the table. “This is just Phase One of his suffering.”

“I would call him again if you need me to.”

“I think we’re done here,” she says.

“I’m just offering . . .”

“You’ve been wonderful, Hannah.”

I get the hint. It’s time to go. I’ve got an inkling why: I think she might want to be alone. Probably wants to play with herself. I wouldn’t blame her at all . . .



We say goodbye at the door a few minutes later. I thank her again for meeting with me, and once more offer up my phone-taunting services. I tell her to call if she needs me. She says she will, then hustles me out. “Thanks for the drinks,” I say, and she nods once, smiling, then closes the hotel room door behind me.

Walking along the hall to the elevator banks, I feel the effect of the whiskey cocktails she served. The geometric pattern on the rug has me swooning, but I laugh to myself thinking of bold and frightening Kristy softening under the mystery of her sexuality, and needing my help breaking it to her husband the things she had done. Thankful I was included. I’d never seen it coming. The ride down in the elevator cab sees me smiling at my reflection the whole way to the lobby. My stomach’s warm, I feel good all over. Like I performed a vital public service. I helped my community. My community of sex freaks. I can’t wait to get home . . .

Part 3

Outro

Back at my apartment, I heat up some leftover Chinese food and eat at my laptop while making notes on my interview with Kristy. But there is this crazy unavoidable tug—we won't go into detail, but I brought out something trusty, rubbery, molded lifelike with the veins and even a retractable foreskin. And when that's done, I have a much clearer head.

When I return to my laptop, Mister Earl jumps in my lap and I stroke his head, feeding him a chicken ball from chopsticks.

Then it hits me.

I laugh, put down my chopsticks and cover my face. Am I fucking stupid?

Maybe I'm wrong, but back in the cool of my apartment, no more dirty talk, two orgasms coaxed out from me by eight thick inches of phthalate-free PVC and I can see it now: I might just have been manipulated.

I look back on my interactions with Kristy, following a trail of breadcrumbs. The subterfuge, the sparse messaging. The brusqueness of our initial contact. Putting me on edge, Kristy knowing I wanted to hear her story and coaxing me close to her. Making me work to like her. Feeding me whiskey. She knows I like whiskey. She feeds me whiskey, puts me in that warm, fuzzy, accepting place. Get's me reaching out to her, drawing her forward. She lets cracks show through her armor, softens before me. Makes me think I'm doing it. Making me think she needs me. Then I'm coaxing it out of her, her ill-suited timidity and worry making me assure her she's okay. That there's nothing wrong with her. Making me console and comfort her. Then, when she asks for participatory help, I'm more than eager to oblige . . .

If it'd happened any other way, I would not have done what I did for Mike on the phone.

The more I think about it, the more convinced I am that I was just a pawn on confident Kristy's sexual chessboard. I'm the rook, moving deep and to the left, coming up behind her King (important note, y'all: I don't know how chess works).

God dammit.

I laugh, set Mister Earl on the floor, throw my takeout containers in the trash. I'm still laughing when I pass by my reflection in the hall mirror. I stop and look at myself. I feel dirty and used. And filled with awe and admiration.

"And you think you're so smart," I say to my reflection. "Look at you. You just got played."

I tip an imaginary hat to Kristy or whatever that woman's name really was.

Cindy From Great Woods

Part 1

Intro

I arranged to meet Cindy at a coffee shop in Steamboat Springs. Cindy of course isn't her real name. Nor are any of the other names I'll be using. She changed them when she wrote me her original letter, and I stuck with the fake names she provided.

I was sitting by the window seat on a sunny day in March, getting my things together, looking out across the wide street at the quaint bookstores and sports shops and art galleries and wondered how a northeastern girl like Cindy ever ended up in the Yampa Valley in northern Colorado. I predicted she liked to ski, given the letter she'd written me.

A car pulls up street-side behind my rental just out front of the coffee shop, and I figure it's Cindy. It's a seven-year-old Subaru; a woman of the approximate age I imagine Cindy to be sits behind the wheel. The Subaru has a roof rack. There are binoculars on the dashboard. I watch the woman gather her things, get out of the Subaru and come into the coffee shop. She has a book under her arm. My Cindy would be fifty-nine years old, and this woman looks good for fifty-nine. She's tall, her blonde hair has a lot of silver in it now, but it's pulled back from her face in a tidy bun. Cindy keeping her hair long, even in her late fifties. She looks fit and trim. Well-dressed in Patagonia. Shirt tucked into khaki shorts that fit her well. She wears sporty hiking shoes and ankle socks. I know it's Cindy.

The woman enters and I rise, give her a wave. It's her. She puts her hand up in greeting as well, gives me a timid smile. The nature of our get-together today is definitely a strange one. One that would provoke the timid smile like this woman shows me. Cindy responded to the post on my website. Didn't send an email, somehow found my physical mailing address through my editor at Sparrow House. The letter I got from Cindy was written by hand. Ten pages, folded in thirds and tucked in a fat envelope. Ten pages of

a heartbreaking story written in her looping and neat ballpoint pen. I couldn't wait to talk to her.

"You must be Cindy," I said.

She said, "You're Hannah. I recognize you from your pictures."

I told her I was glad to finally put a face to her name. She gave an embarrassed shrug, joined me at my table, sitting across from me and lifting up the menu. Her book was on the table. A field guide for birds. I asked her if she's a birdwatcher. She says she is. It gets her out of the house.

She orders a coffee. When it arrives, she puts milk in it. No sugar. I'm anxious to talk to her, but I want to get to know her first. I asked her how she ended up in Steamboat Springs. I was right about the skiing, though it wasn't what she came to Colorado for. She came to Colorado for her husband's work. She's not wearing a wedding ring. I'll ask her about it later, I figure.

She tells me she has two daughters. Grown now, both of them almost forty. One of them had a divorce and has moved back to Colorado. She asks me how I am. How was my flight? What do I think of Steamboat Springs? I'm polite and tell her how wonderful her hometown is. She says her hometown is still upstate New York, just outside the city. I asked her if she gets up there anymore. She doesn't. She hasn't been in New York State in a long time. I tell her everything is changed, anyway. She says things never stay the same. I tell her how right she is.

There's a question that's been nagging me, so I ask her. "How on earth did you come to know about my blog?"

"My granddaughters," she said.

"They read my articles?" I grimace.

"They were forbidden."

"Then how . . .?"

“Through church,” she said, and I laughed, seeing now exactly where this was going. Cindy’s church put out a watch list. Mother’s, beware of these individuals. I was on that list.

“Sure enough,” Cindy told me, “My daughters and I checked the girls’ devices, and they’d read one of your articles. They were twelve and eleven at the time. Now, I know what you wrote is merely progressive and meant to be helpful, but you were promptly blocked.”

“I hope I didn’t get them in trouble.”

“They weren’t in trouble. Your articles were . . . brash, but advisory. I read one of them—”

“When Is It Too Long?”

She nodded, raised her eyebrows. “It brought back . . .” Cindy goes wistful, and I remind her, yes, I know, I’ve read her letter. I don’t add: about a hundred times.

Cindy said, “My church warned me about you.”

“And you didn’t heed.”

“I read all your articles. It made me think of . . . him.”

“Tommy.”

Cindy goes wistful again, and I note she won’t repeat his name.

When it gets quiet too long, I gather from my bag those ten sheets of folded paper and flatten them. She’s sheepish at their sight. I tell her how much I loved what she sent me. I’ve already gushed, told her many times over email. I show her how dogeared I’ve made her pages. I asked her why she would do it by hand. She says because it was too important for it to be weightless. I touched the paper. The paper has weight. Emails are nothing. If there were no electricity, they wouldn’t exist. But Cindy’s story existed. It had weight. I loved it. This is what she wrote to me.

Part 2

Cindy's Story

I was a nineteen-and-a-half-year-old virgin engaged to be married to my father's business partner's nephew when I fell for a boy named Tommy Healy. It was the late summer of 1979, and I was working at the Great Woods Christian summer camp for good girls and boys in upstate New York. I'd been working there since graduating from the Counselors-In-Training program when I was just thirteen. All through high school my summers were spent at Great Woods. The summers before I worked there, I'd spent as a Great Woods happy camper. My husband-to-be, Charlie Whitaker, a good young man whom I knew would be an excellent husband, had been chosen by my mother and father due to his fine family, and good Christian values. Plus, he was part of the family business in a roundabout way, being the nephew of Michael Whitaker, a guy my dad had gone to college with and started their electronic supply business together. It was an arranged marriage, I suppose, though it was never really presented to me as such. It was like my parents knew that the proposition of an arranged marriage would be an objectionable thing to present to a young liberated woman in the modern day, even back in the late 70s. So, instead, my love life had been kept pruned and weeded, the lone flower growing in my garden of potential suitors was Charlie Whitaker.

And, look, Charlie was a handsome guy. Tall, too. And, although my parents would've lost their minds to discover, a pretty good kisser. Yes, even though we were both good Christians, good kids really, when left to our own devices we often walked paths that would have worried our parents. So, being put on the path of engagement-wedding-marriage and then future family with Charlie Whitaker was in no way a bad prospect. It was a good prospect. A very good thing for me, and, to be honest, in many ways it removed a lot of angst that some of my other friends felt. Of course, those friends bounced around from boyfriend to boyfriend, and none of their parents had set them up with a tall, handsome guy who looked like he had a good future ahead of him.

I never took it for granted, but of course there were times that I found it difficult. Hormones and all, you see. Because while Charlie was the nephew of Michael Whitaker, he did not live in the same town. Which meant I didn't get to see my only boyfriend very much at all. While most of the time I could keep myself busy with school work or my extracurriculars (I loved swimming, swam on the high school team, was part of my orienteering club, canoeing club, headed up indoor activities as well, like Masters of Chess), there were dark teenage times when certain feelings took over. Though I knew it was a sin, I engaged in practices of self-pleasure. Things that drove me wild and frightened me with the fear of being caught, though in retrospect now were quite funny. My mother had a heat cushion for her neck that had a vibration feature. When I discovered what I could do with that, there were times my hands were shaking waiting for my sisters and for my parents to leave the house so I could whip that thing out from under the master bedroom vanity, bring it into my bedroom and plug it in, squeeze it between my legs and hug my pillow.

And there were other times, too, where the proximity of male partners in college made my stomach squirm. Charlie didn't go to the same university as me, either. It was a four-and-a-half hour drive's distance, so I was only seeing him once a month. In those times, even, we weren't engaged in sex. In high school, we'd made out a lot, he'd even felt me up through my clothes. One time I put my hand between his legs and felt the turgid bulge in his cotton khakis. That feel against my hand had to last, because it was years before I'd actually ever even seen his thing.

It was in college where I'd finally given my future husband his first hand job. A wild and crazy night, that was for sure. Put crazy tingles and lubricious feelings in my stomach. Made feel light as a feather for days following. I'd wondered if I'd had an orgasm, the pleasure was so intense. I'd wanted to do it, you see. Charlie didn't. But once I had his fly down and I was working my hand into the open folds, he couldn't say no any longer. He trembled and shook as I took his thing out. The first one I'd ever seen. The first one—then it would go without explanation—to feel in my hand. It was mesmerizing. I watched it the whole while I stroked it. Hand going up and down, amazed at how hard this part of him could be. Wondered what it was like when it wasn't hard. I'd never seen one, other than drawings in

textbooks. No, that wasn't true, there was a picture shared from a book with a naked couple on a beach, shown to me by one of the girls on the swim team, the two of us with hearts racing, so afraid of being caught looking at this simple picture of a naked hippie couple. A man and woman, the woman looking not unlike me, tall with lank blonde hair. The bearded hippy man was turned sideways, and his pubic hair was tremendous. The picture was blown out, so whatever it was that stood out from his pubic hair faded in contrast with the sparkling water behind him. I imagined a faint dark line described the underside of what would be his penis. But, really, just seeing a man with nothing on put butterflies in my stomach, visible penis or not. Then that night with Charlie, there I was taking charge. A guy I loved. A guy I would marry. Yes, we were sworn to celibacy, waiting for our marriage night, but those rare sessions on couches, lips and mouths working together, tongues twirling, hands roaming . . . well, you can only be so strong for so long.

"It's okay," I assured Charlie, using my hand on him and kissing his chin. Because it wasn't sex. We weren't doing anything drastic. I was just wanting to see what he had. Wanting to share something with him that felt so right (to me, at least). It was all over so quickly, anyway. Poor Charlie ejaculated in a very short time. All over his robin's egg blue shirt, staining it. He'd got mad, ran into the bathroom, blaming me at first, then blaming himself while I sat on the couch bewildered at the sight of semen erupting from a boy's urethra, cleaning the pearly webbing off my fingers with a tissue.

So that was only one time I'd engaged in anything legitimately sexual. One interaction.

But there was always something weighing on my mind. Before I'd been engaged in trothplight with my parents' marital selection, Charlie had had a girlfriend before. And as strong as I could be most of the time, there was a percentage of time where I wondered what things had been like between this other girl and Charlie. Had she done anything to him? For him? Had she used her hand—or goodness, even her mouth—sometime in his past, also sending him scurrying into the bathroom in a flurry of shame?

Tommy Healy had been a Great Woods counselor for three of the summers I'd been there. My last year of high school, after my first year of college, and that fateful summer after the second year of college. Tommy had lots of counselor experience; he'd worked at one of the other big camps upstate, but his parents had moved, and Great Woods was so much closer that he applied there. He was tall, at least as tall as Charlie, lean, always tanned (because I'd only seen him in the summers), the longest legs I'd seen on a guy; a head of golden curls that got lighter and blonder each passing week of the summer. Best thing about Tommy was his sense of humor. It was so easy to be his friend. Always in a good mood, always happy. Always looking to please. So great with the kids, too. And an expert paddler. Up every morning, out on the water before the day started, cutting across Lake Wennibisko with his shirt off, those ropey muscles twitching as he stroked his paddle through the water. It'd be crazy to think that I didn't have feelings for him. Well, before anything happened between us, at least. I was young and curious, and he was one of the cutest counselors there. Whatever it was I felt before that summer, I'd quashed it because of Charlie. And, thankfully, nothing had ever happened between me and Tommy, anyway. In the previous summers, he'd get a thing going with one of the other girls, anyway. Everybody knew that I had a boyfriend, and things were serious. Serious enough that we were going to be married. So, the guy counsellors tended to leave me alone. There was always the wonder if something one of them said was meant to spark some interest, or if it was just natural boyish bravado.

That summer of 1979 I was two years away from my wedding date, and I hadn't seen Charlie all summer long. He got himself a job working deliveries for his father's company, driving the interstates in the Midwest, and he'd write me weekly letters about all the sights he'd seen, tucking in a post card from wherever he'd been: Sioux City, or Grand Island, or Lincoln . . . And during the final two months of college, he hadn't been able to visit

once. We'd gone one time to a family function (the Whitaker's and the McKenzie's getting together for a company picnic), and we'd made out, but that had just left me feeling even more desire than if I hadn't seen Charlie at all. I was nineteen-and-a-half and nobody had ever done more than kiss me. Charlie had handled my breasts through my clothes, but had never touched between my legs. Not even over my pants.

One Sunday, mid-August, in the transition between two camping sessions, I found myself spending a Sunday with Tommy Healy, no camp kids around, just a bunch of Christian camp counselors riding bikes, playing guitar, swimming, canoeing, reading and relaxing. I hung out with Tommy that day, and things went too far.

We rode our bikes off camp property, up the old dirt mining road, heading to the Cedar Ridge swimmin' hole where we thought we'd go jumping off the abandoned trestle bridge. It was just the two of us, though others were invited. It was really hot that day, I remember, and none of the other counselors wanted to get all sweaty riding their bikes all the way uphill to get to the bridge.

We arrived late afternoon, wheeled our bikes into the empty picnic area. We hustled up the embankment, then stood on the bridge, chatting and spitting, and we shared a bottle of Coke. After that, we were down into our swim trunks (I'd boldly worn my two piece, but remember it was very hot), on the old trestle bridge in the shade under arching maples, jumping the fifteen-foot distance, yelling the whole way down before splashing in the water. We paddled around the lagoon at an elbow in the river, talking about what we were going to do next year. Tommy asked me about Charlie, and I felt open enough with Tommy to speak honestly. I told him I just don't see him enough.

He said, "When are you guys getting married?"

"Summer, two years from now."

"You have a dress and everything?"

"No, nothing like that at all."

“You excited?”

“Of course,” I said, cupping my hands together and shoveling water at his face. He slipped under the waves, came up farther away, laughing at me and saying it was just an innocent question.

“Of course I am,” I said. “I love Charlie. He’s a great guy.”

“I met him,” Tommy said. “He’ll be a good husband.”

“You think I’ll be a good wife?”

He laughed. “You tell me.”

I took offense to that. I said, “You don’t think I’ll be a good wife?”

“I didn’t say that.”

“No, but you didn’t jump in with the right answer. Turning it around on me, asking me what I thought. I asked you what you thought.”

“I think,” he said, looking quite serious, “Charlie will be a very lucky man to have you as his wife.”

“That’s better,” I said, and we drifted closer.

He said, “How long’ve you guys been going out?”

And then I told Tommy the situation. Never really told anybody about it truthfully, other than that Charlie and I had been engaged for a long time. But I never really framed it as an arranged marriage. Tommy’s eyes widened. “Your parents set you guys up?”

“Yeah,” I said, feeling a little ashamed and sorry that I’d told him.

Tommy was careful with his words, like he knew it might be easy to hurt my feelings. I already knew what he was going to say. How can we be sure if we’re right for each other if our parents set us up before we were even really adults?

Tommy said, “So you dated Charlie since high school?”

“I did.”

“And you never dated anybody else?”

“No,” I said, and couldn’t hide the embarrassment. I got to my back, and was flutter kicking in reverse, heading to shore and feeling unworldly.

Tommy stayed out, hoping I would return to him, but I was too distressed by the revelation of my situation. I went up to where our things were at shore, this sandy little stretch of beach that we had to ourselves that rose up to a grassy swath with a lone picnic table on it. There was a fire pit on the beach, just an old rusted wheel with charred logs in it. I sat with my feet in the sand, my ass on the grass, drying my face in my towel as Tommy swam back to shore. He strolled up the beach, body gleaming. All the cords and cables in his arms, chest, and shoulders looked very good to me in the late afternoon sun. It wasn’t the first time I’d ogled his body, but now, given the circumstances, I felt a funny spark. My eyes scanned his body, peeping over the edge of my towel, looking at the wet bulge in the crotch of his shorts.

Something had stuck with me for the last year. Gracia, a counselor visiting from Columbia, tittering late one night with some perverted news, getting all the other girls clambering to her bedside wanting to know the salacious details. She’d been coy with us, drawing out the moment, almost telling us, then changing her mind. Saying in her accent, “No, I cannot, it’s too . . .”

We’d urged her. Finally, Gracia hid her mouth from us, just her big round eyes sticking up from the gathered sheets, saying from behind them, “Alice saw Tommy naked.”

There was a certain feeling of being let down. It wasn’t as crazy as we’d thought it was going to be. So Alice’d seen Tommy naked. We’d all seen him practically naked, just in his athletic shorts on the beach. But there was a greater detail to come. One that had hit me in a strange way, strange enough that it’d lasted like a sliver in the back of my brain all these hundreds of days later.

Gracia had moved down the sheet, then said (almost reverently), “She saw his penis.”

We all already figured that Alice’d seen his penis, but something about Grace’s presentation told us that there was another shoe ready to drop.

All us hushed girls said, “What? What is it?” Already guessing what it was going to be, but needing to hear it. Gracia said it quick: “Alice said it looked like an elephant trunk.”

We teen counselor girls burst into quiet snuffling laughter, poking Gracia’s legs, Gracia kicking under the sheets. Then she sat up again, putting her feet on the floor. She did a karate chop mid thigh, said, “Like this, she said.” Her expression defying them to disagree.

“No,” we gasped. It was the thing we were all horrified to hear, wanted to hear, and were elated to hear. An awful teen girl juxtaposition, knotting all of us up, I’m sure.

Whatever it was about Gracia’s story, it had put the funniest feeling in my stomach. Four days later, it was still all I could think of. Watching for a glimpse of movement behind Tommy’s tight white Adidas shorts. Sure, there was a bulge. But nothing that would suggest that it was an elephant trunk in there. And what did that mean, anyway?—an elephant trunk . . . I wanted to ask Alice who’d seen it firsthand, but I didn’t want to seem like one of those girls. So I suffered without further information. By the time camp session rolled around that summer of 1979, sure, the thought had lingered, but that crazy prickly feeling in my stomach was gone. Just then, sitting on the beach, Tommy walking my way, it returned. Maybe something showed on my face, because Tommy’s eyes met mine in a strange and different way. It was uncomfortable, and I looked away.

“Hey, I didn’t mean to—”

“It’s no big deal,” I said.

He came and sat next to me, keeping a foot-and-a-half of distance between our hips. He said, “Yeah, right. It’s no big deal. You love him anyway.”

“I do. I know what you’re thinking.”

“No, you don’t.”

“I can imagine what you’re thinking,” I said. “That I’m about to spend my entire life with the same guy and there’s this major part of our lives that’s unknown—it’s going to begin on our wedding night and I don’t know anything about it. I don’t know what he’s like . . .”

“So you guys never . . .”

“Tommy,” I moaned, like I didn’t want to talk about it—though I did.

“You can talk to me.”

I really did want to talk to him. So I said, “We’ve done hand stuff.”

“You have?” His tone was hopeful, and that bothered me. Like I wasn’t as big a know-nothing as he’d thought.

“Yeah, I have.”

“On him?”

I tsk-ed, like I was mad at him. Then he acted hurt, putting out a hand to hold on to my wrist. I looked at the handsome shapes of his tanned hand against my slender wrist. Leather cords campers had tied for him strapped his wrist. He felt very safe, very friendly, and maybe this was something I should talk about. So I told him. “I did something for him. With my hand . . .”

Tommy nodded, brow crinkled, assessing what I'd revealed. "I guess that's good."

"You guess?"

"No, it is good. It's, you know . . . I guess . . . Kind of . . . what it's like—"

"You don't even sound convincing," I said.

He laughed, stroked my wrist bone with his thumb. Both of us were quiet for a long moment, and all I could think about was his hand on me. Maybe he was thinking it, too, knowing that I was engaged. He let my wrist go, linked his fingers together between his knees. He said, "Some of us are like that."

"Christians?"

I could see him nodding in my periphery. "You're not?"

He looked at me. "Am I a virgin?"

Hearing that word from a boy's mouth tightened my stomach. "Yeah," I said, feeling funny about saying Yeah, biting my lower lip and running my hair behind my ear.

"No, I'm not. My parents are okay with that."

"My parents wouldn't be," I said, looking out at the sun sparkling on the waves.

"You have to wait two years?"

“I do,” I said, sighing, resigned to it.

“No offense: lotta good years between here and there.”

“Charlie’s committed to celibacy.”

Tommy wriggled his brow. “Well, the man’s got convictions.”

I nodded, brow furrowed, chewing my lip. And then I uttered to him my most secret worry, and, boy, it felt great to share: “Charlie had a girlfriend before me.”

He looked toward me, head cocked sympathetically.

“Don’t give me that face,” I said, “Don’t you feel sorry for me . . .”

“I’m not,” he said, putting up his hands, “I just don’t think you should worry.”

“What—don’t worry about what some other girl did with him?”

“Why would you worry about that?”

“Because,” I said, gesturing angrily out toward the water in frustration, “Of course I would worry about that—what if when it comes down to it, I’m no good at it?”

“You’ll be good at it,” he said.

“But what if I’m not as good as her?”

“Do you know her?”

I looked at him incredulously. “What does that matter?”

“I don’t know if it matters or not. I doubt she’s more beautiful than you are.”

He looked right at me when he said it.

That funny feeling slithered through me again. And though I should have stopped him right there, nipped that in the bud, I didn't. Instead, I quietly said, "Thank you."

"Is that why you did the hand thing?"

I shrugged. "Maybe." Then: "No. I just really wanted to do that for him."

"You liked it?"

I showed him a look that said I didn't want to talk about that.

He said, "Some girls like to do that—it's not a big deal."

I rolled my eyes. "Yes, I admit it. I wanted to do it. I liked it." It made me want to giggle, being so forthcoming about something so secret yet ridiculous.

"He won't let you do it again?"

I made an exasperated sound. I'd intended it to mean I was exasperated with Tommy's line of questioning, but in retrospect I was probably more exasperated with Charlie. Why wouldn't he want me to do that for him? Why wouldn't he touch me? My stomach began to ache, and I rested my hand over it.

"And you've never had another boyfriend?"

"I told you I didn't."

He smiled to one side, said, "What if Charlie's worried too? Like he's thinking maybe he's not any good?"

"Guys don't think that," I said.

"Sure they do. Of course they do—you'd have to be crazy not to think that."

His dramatic answer made me laugh. “That makes me feel better,” I told him.

“It’s not easy to please a woman.”

I said, “I think I’m probably pretty easy to please,” then burst out laughing at my ridiculous statement. How lewd and obvious and completely improper. My laugh echoed across the water, and Tommy joined in.

I looked at him more warmly, and those feelings of friendship returned. Tommy said, “You’re worried maybe just like he’s worried.”

“Right. Except he had a girlfriend.”

“Not as good as you.”

“Maybe not. But maybe he doesn’t want me to use my hand on him again because I was so much worse than his other girlfriend. Maybe he’s sick with worry that he’s gonna be stuck with me forever and I don’t even know what I’m doing.”

“I’m sure you know what you’re doing.”

“What if I don’t?” I said, laughing into my hands.

“Did he . . . finish?”

I groaned into my hands, feeling uncomfortable but not averse. I said, “Yeah. he did,” thinking of how happy I was to see Charlie’s jetting release.

“Then you did it good,” he said, and we both laughed.

Tommy gathered up a handful of rocks collected below the scruffy grass edge in the rise between sand and lawn, shook them loose like he was sifting for gold, taking the bigger nuggets then and tossing them into the water, making them blip and bloop. I watched him for the longest time, cheek in my hand, feeling very good about this handsome guy who I’d known for so long. Those wonderful sunny outdoor summers where we helped raise good future citizens together. Watched the way the muscles

moved in his arms, the tiny little folds in his flat stomach, that funny little curl of hair—gosh, pubic hair!—just above the waistband of his swim trunks.

Out of the blue, he said, “You want to go swimming again?”

“I don’t want to go back to camp yet,” I said.

“Wonder if we should stay later,” he said, looking around, “Maybe build a fire here . . .”

“There’s wood in that metal thingy out by the road,” I said.

Tommy looked at me a long moment, then changed the subject of the fire and firewood, saying, “There’re experiences you can have in the next two years. In case you’re worried about missing anything . . .”

“I already told you he doesn’t want to do things.”

Tommy stood up then, taking a step away, turning to face me. “Not with Charlie. Unless he wants to.”

I frowned, suddenly thinking he was up to something that would offend me. Something that would ruin our friendship. But he didn’t look lecherous, he looked supportive. He said, “In two years, you can have some fun experiences that you’ll get to remember when you’re married to Charlie. Fun things you did, that you can look back on . . .”

“I have lots of those.”

“But I mean ones that stand out.”

“They all kinda stand out.”

He said, “You’re not following.”

I said, “I’m not.”

“You never horsed around with guys or anything?”

I made a dubious, suspecting expression. “Horsed around how?”

He smiled, chuckled lightly and closed his eyes. When he opened them again, he said, “Let’s go skinny-dipping . . .”

I laughed and hid my face in my hands. “I’m not going skinny-dipping,” I hollered into my palms. “Don’t be crazy.”

“Why not?” he said, “Beautiful day, we’re alone. Nobody’s coming down that lonely road on a Sunday. Especially not so late in the day. Let’s just go swimming . . .”

“Without any clothes on?” I said sarcastically.

“You’re the one making it a big deal,” he said, cocking an eyebrow and smirking.

I said, “I don’t know . . .” Like I was actually considering this thing. I mean, why the hell not? There wasn’t anything wrong with it. Was there? Just two young people enjoying nature . . .

I laughed into my palms again, hands cupped around my nose and mouth, but my eyes on Tommy. I opened my hands and said, “You know, I’ve never seen one except Charlie’s.” And what on earth was that, right? Looking at it now, it was so obvious. Right there in that moment, I’d asked to see Tommy’s penis. And yes, also in retrospect, it was definitely my imagination working in the back of my mind, that wonder about the thing that Gracia’d said Alice had witnessed. An elephant trunk. My statement had come out of nowhere, and though I’d embarrassed myself, it couldn’t be retracted. I groaned, laughed it off and looked away.

“Come on swimming then,” he said, taking another step back.

“I don’t know . . .”

But now Tommy knew he had me. Knew I was on the lip and was ready to fall in . . .

“Hey,” he said, and when I looked up, he flipped down the front of his shorts, tugged them down in the V between his thighs. Below his tangle of pubic hair, I saw the top part of his penis. The shaft was a veiny hose of wrinkled, sagging skin. I squealed and pretended to block the view. But I was still looking. When Tommy saw I wasn’t recoiling or turning away, or running for my bicycle, the shorts were pushed down further to mid thigh. And between Tommy’s legs hung something that did look quite like an elephant trunk. A prominent dangling hose of brownish man flesh. He had lean legs, and the thickness of his penis was substantial. It swung lazily between his open thighs as his shorts were pushed to his knees, and my eyebrows rose high into my hairline. My mouth had fallen open, but my face pulled back in hilarity. I cupped my hands over my mouth and bellowed laughter into them. In that moment, I’d become mesmerized by a man’s penis. I’d never seen one other than Charlie’s. But the sight of what Tommy had was instantly known to me as a dominant, masculine example. The thing that swayed between his legs was bigger than that turgid shaft that had throbbed bolt upright between Charlie’s legs that night I used my hand on him. Longer and thicker, and Tommy wasn’t even hard.

He kicked off his shorts, his thing dancing and flopping around. I couldn’t breathe. I couldn’t pull my eyes away. I was stuck somewhere between wanting to fall down laughing, and also succumbing to this sudden tightness of lust that seized through me, made me feel sick to my stomach and raced my heart. That thing between Tommy’s legs had one major purpose in the presence of a young woman. I knew what that purpose was. I knew what it was for. I’d been dutifully warned by my mother. And Tommy exposed his to me. Showed it to me. I was an engaged woman, and another man was presenting something private and intimate to me that he was obviously very proud of. He wanted me to see it and wanted me to like it. That made me like it more. The illicit nature of Tommy’s exposure soared me to terrible erotic heights. And I was frozen, seized into inaction. Unable to say anything. Unable to object, unable to agree, unable to stand and join him, unable to run to my bike and pedal back to the safety of camp.

Now that his shorts were off he was trying to act like it was no big deal his penis was out. Stepping toward me, that thing looming larger in my vision,

putting a hand out saying, “Come on, Cindy, come out swimming with me . . .”

“With my things off?” I said, voice tight.

“Live a little,” he said, in his soft, kind and caring, but very masculine way.

And then it was like a trapdoor in my stomach opened, and a walloping weight of intense fear fell away. I was suddenly able to stand. Able to get up, stand face to face with Tommy, this naked guy with a really huge penis. I said, “A collection of experiences?”

“Skinny dipping. You might not ever do it with Charles . . .”

Tommy’s sweet smile convinced me. Charlie would never do this. And this was fun.

“Don’t look,” I said, folding my arms behind my back to untie my bikini top.

“It’s no fun if I don’t look.”

Maybe he was right. “You’re going to look?” I said, practically scolding him, but still untying. The strings fell free, and I pushed away the bra straps, let another man who I would never marry see my bare breasts.

The sudden surge of blood into my nipples hurt in a way that I can’t describe, but I can still feel today. Never in my life has it ever been repeated that arousal came so suddenly that my nipples ached the way they did that day. It felt like they’d been whacked with a ruler. Right before his eyes they went to bolts—but I wasn’t ashamed, instead I let him look, began to thumb down my bikini pants.

“That’s the spirit,” he said, walking backward, his eyes moving up and down my body. And I thumbed down my bikini bottoms while I watched Tommy’s naked dick dangling so long between his legs. It really did look almost to mid thigh, just as April had indicated to Gracia, and Gracia to us.

I stepped out of the bikini bottoms, suddenly then feeling like I needed to hide myself, but turning and arranging them, shaking out the sand, knowing he would be looking at my naked derrière. At nineteen I was unashamed of my figure, though I did much to hide it so as not to give boys the wrong idea. A splash behind me told me Tommy was in the water, and I turned and ran before he broke surface so he wouldn't see my breasts jostle and bounce as I dove in behind him, striding through the water to mid thigh then plunging head first. I came up nearby and let out the most joyous hoot. The sound echoed, Tommy laughed then imitated it, hands cupped around his mouth like the old Tarzan movies, imitating my expulsion of release. He splashed water at me and asked, "Feel good being naked?"

"It does," I said, and it really did. I'd had a great day already with Tommy, we had so much fun together. I felt at ease with him. And suddenly, doing this crazy thing with him, as inappropriate as it was, didn't feel so bad. I felt very grateful to him in that moment. Like he'd given me a gift. I never noticed that I'd been twisted tight by an uneasy tension, but floating naked in the water with Tommy, I felt a heaviness that wasn't there anymore. A freedom, maybe.

We swam in circles, dog paddled and talked like we weren't even naked. Then we took turns swimming to the edge, climbing the bridge with no clothes on, clambering to the midpoint and jumping off the old creosote railway ties into the water below. Like two human beings having the best day without a care in the world. Totally free and totally naked. I loved watching Tommy's body without clothes. Loved watching the way his stomach moved, loved the roundness of his bare boy ass. And loved watching his man parts flop and swing. Loved it when he would jump off the bridge, and his penis would go upright, his testicles too, pinned to his stomach for a moment until he plunged into the water. After a while, it was almost like we weren't naked anymore. I was used to it. Comfortable. The sky changed from blue, going to deeper colors, and orange began to flood on the horizon.

We paddled close together. I could tell Tommy was proud of himself. Proud that he'd encouraged me to have fun of the dirtiest kind. At least the dirtiest I was capable of allowing. I smiled wryly.

“It was a great day,” he said simply.

“It was,” I said, “thank you.”

“I should thank you. I had as good a day as you did—you really are the best girl. Charlie is lucky and I hope he appreciates what he’s getting.”

“I think he does,” I said.

“Are you going to tell him what happened today?”

I laughed. “Are you kidding?”

“Tsk-tsk,” he said, “Cindy’s keeping secrets.”

“I don’t think he’d understand.”

“I’m only teasing, anyway. You’re allowed to have things for yourself.”

I said, “I wish Charlie was the kind of guy who would do this with me.”

“Well, Cindy, I’ll always be the guy you can do this with.”

“Behind my husband’s back?” I said, laughing.

He shoveled water at me, and I shoveled water at him. We engaged then in a game of skimming water at each other, laughing, dipping under the surface, coming up in unexpected places. But then we were really close together, bobbing our faces only feet apart.

“I’d do that,” I said.

“Meet with me when you’re married, and we’ll go skinny dipping?”

“Maybe,” I said coyly.

“Give me a call anytime. We’ll pick the nearest swimming hole. Wherever you and Charlie what’s-his-name end up.”

“Whitaker. I’m going to be Cindy Whitaker.”

“I’ll send you Christmas cards with pictures of Santa swimming in the ocean.”

I laughed, smoothed hair back from my face, blinking at him. Him blinking at me. Both of our chins under the water, sucking in water then spouting it at each other. I said, “I just wish he’d let me play around with him a little.”

Tommy nodded, took a mouthful of water, arced a spout high enough I had to swim aside. He said, “I’m always here for that, too . . .”

“Tom-my,” I said, scolding him, actually kind of mad. But I’d set him up to say that. I didn’t even realize it at the time, but it was my own behavior shaping what happened that day. I whipped around like I was mad at him, giving him the cold shoulder.

“So dramatic,” he laughed. “Tres dramatique.”

“How dare you,” I said, but I didn’t swim away.

When Tommy didn’t say anything for too long, I finally faced him. He was down low, watching me still, his expression very serious. I got down low, too, and mimicked his expression. Both of us looking very serious and contemplating each other, bobbing in the water as the sun went down.

I was the one who broke the silence. “I’ve only ever . . . done anything with Charlie.”

“I know,” he said.

“Is that bad?”

“I wouldn’t judge you.”

“But what would others think?”

“Do you care?”

I shook my head no.

Tommy bobbed closer until we were only a foot apart. My heart raced; I knew what would happen, what he wanted to happen. I was afraid of what I wanted to happen.

He said, “Despite what you might think, despite what your parents tell you, the things you do aren’t bad.”

“It would be wrong,” I told him.

“What would be wrong?”

“What you’re asking.”

“I’m not asking anything, Cindy.”

“Then what are we talking about?”

He chewed his lip for a second, then said, “You worry about pleasing Charlie. Worry you don’t have experience.”

I nodded. That was an agreeable statement. That didn’t send me running—even though I knew where he was going with this. “I do . . .”

“Maybe you wouldn’t worry if you had experience . . .”

I whispered, “I can’t do that . . .”

Tommy stayed with it. “You wanted him to be happy, and you weren’t sure you were good enough.”

“Oh, so you’d tell me if I’m good enough?”

He didn’t laugh, and he wasn’t offended. He got closer, his hands went to my arms. My nipples ached and my sex throbbed with heat despite how cold it was underwater. I hitched in a breath, held it.

He said, “You want to know?”

Then I was frozen by his gaze, biting on my lower lip and nodding rapidly.

“So find out . . .”

I was still nodding when he kissed me, his mouth coming to mine. I put my hands on his nice neck, took his cold, wet, but very plump lips with my own and kissed another man. Then I pushed him away. “I can’t, Tommy . . .”

“Don’t go . . .”

Slowly, I was able to breathe again. “I’m not,” I said, “I’m not going.”

He came closer again, and I told him not to kiss me.

“I won’t.”

Then I said: “Can I . . .”

“What?”

“Can I . . . touch it?”

His hands stroked my shoulders down to my elbows. “Yeah,” he said, and I could tell by his posture and the movement of his mouth he wanted to kiss me again. I tucked my chin down and turned my cheek aside. All I wanted to know was what it would feel like to hold his thing. I wanted to become familiar with it. I wanted to please it . . .

My hands were shaking as my fingertips touched his chest. I dragged them down, feeling his ribs and sternum, my two hands coming together between his legs as we floated under the old trestle bridge. I snaked my grip around his huge penis. Closed my hands on its squishy shape. The lust came booming through me. I gasped, and the sound I made electrified Tommy. I could see it in his eyes. His eyes narrowed, his mouth hung open, and now it was me fighting hard not to kiss him. He was huge in my hands. Soft and squirming, a pliable masculine appendage. So incredibly large and sexy.

I asked, “Is this okay?”

“Yeah,” he said, “it is.”

“It feels good?” I asked timidly.

He nodded. Then his cock surged in my hand, lengthened and thickened, the floppiness ceasing, becoming a much straighter and hard-to-bend thing. Feeling that sexual arousal, knowing what that indicated, and looking into Tommy’s eyes scared the hell out of me. The wrongness of what I was doing ballooned inside me and my hands fled. Jumped off his penis like I’d touched a hot pan. I paddled backward, a look of shock on my face. He wanted me back saying, “It’s okay, Cindy, it’s okay . . .”

But then I was swimming. Doing side stroke all the way to shore. Coming up onto the sand hunched over completely naked and ashamed. The light had gone bluish now, but my bikini was bright against the dark of the grass.

I went through the sand, grabbed my things and sat to get dressed. Tommy was coming after me, feet on the bottom now, striding through waist-deep water, emerging, his penis fully hard. That soft floppy thing transformed now into a monstrous pole-arm with one intent. Thrust out from between his legs, lightly bowed, a plump gargantuan knot on the end of it as it danced until he found easier stride on the beach. He came right to me, that offensive male thing pointing at me, accusing me. I leaned away in case it would touch me.

“Don’t freak out,” he said, “it’s okay, Cindy, I’ll put my clothes on.”

And when Tommy didn’t press (and I’d been sure he would), I hunched away from him, still naked, leaning to one side with my bikini gathered at my crotch. I eyed him as he moved to my side, bending over and snatching up his shorts, standing then in profile to me, holding the shorts up at head height looking for the tag at the back to get them on right side front. His erection thrust out from his hips, wagging and nodding, incredibly long. I stopped him. “Wait, Tommy . . .”

He found the back of his shorts, lowered them, put them to one hip and stood looking at me. “You’re okay?”

I nodded. “I just panicked.”

“Sorry if I freaked you out.”

“You didn’t do anything wrong.”

“I tried not to . . .”

I snuffled laughter. “You tried not to get hard?”

He chuckled too, erection dancing. “That why you freaked out?”

I timidly wagged a curled finger to point at his penis. “You have an erection.”

He looked down at it, looked up, said, “Well, you gave it to me.”

“So it’s my fault now?” I was finally able to look at him again. Look up to his face and meet his gaze.

He smiled. “You sure you’re okay?”

“I’m okay,” I said.

“We were having fun.”

I twisted up my mouth, feeling sheepish. I said, “You know my mom has panic attacks?”

“You worry that’s what that was? A panic attack?”

“Kind of.”

“We don’t have to do anything at all, Cindy, just come back swimming with me.”

“It’s getting late though. We should probably head back to camp.”

“Okay,” he said, coming to sit next to me. I played around with my bikini, sorting top from bottom. He said, “I think I have to wait a little while.”

“Why?”

“I can’t ride my bike like this.” He nodded his chin between his legs.

I looked over to see he was still hard, that long thing thrust up from between his legs, dark against his already tanned thighs. I said, “We can wait a bit. Does it take long to go away?”

“Sometimes.”

I scooted closer. Came to sit next to him. Both of us naked and not submerged, our nude bodies no longer hidden by water. Two naked teenagers, side-by-side. Curious girl. Erect male. I already knew what I wanted, but was reluctant to ask. Tommy’d hunched over to hide his arousal, blocking its view with his arms. But now he moved his arms away,

sat straighter so I could see it. I palmed the inside of his thigh, got him to open his legs. I watched his testicles sag and then hang below his enormous erection. I asked: "It's still okay?"

"It is."

I was still reluctant, biting my lip, sliding my wet palm up his thigh, watching now as his testicles seemed to roll over in his scrotum, pull up tighter to hug the wide base of his shaft. I slowly closed my hand around Tommy Healy's huge erection. "Oh my gosh," I wheezed.

Tommy groaned. I felt his pulse in my grip. He was as thick as my own wrist.

"Holy cow," I whispered.

Tommy groaned again.

"You're huge."

"I'm a little big," he said, a gentleman.

"A little big," I said, laughing, "what an oxymoron."

He said, "I guess I'm bigger than Charlie."

"Like way bigger," I said, "way, way bigger."

He smirked, and I blushed, looked away.

"That's okay," he said softly, and I turned back, feeling bashful, but committed to exploring this thing that excited me so much.

"Wow," I said again, squishing his hardness, feeling the thing pulse against my palm. I tried to close my fingers around it, but could barely get middle finger to touch thumb without squishing what I thought would be too hard on him. He groaned and shifted his hips as I did.

"Did that hurt?"

“Nah, feels good.”

Then I watched his face, my hand slowly moving higher up his shaft, watching his eyes flutter, watching his expression try to remain static, but the closer I got to the tip the more his eyes narrowed, the more the muscles of his jaw unhinged. “Does it feel really good?”

“It does,” he said.

“That’s good,” I said, beginning to circle and choke just under the fat, bulbous head.

“So good,” he said, holding my wrist, then showing me what he liked. Gently guiding my hand to stroke up and down, not too much, not below mid shaft before returning up to squish on the plumpness of his cock head. He said, “Charlie should tell you what he wants.”

“He won’t even let me touch it anymore.”

“You don’t ever talk to him about it?”

“He doesn’t want to talk about it,” I said, heart absolutely pounding in my chest. Tommy’s cock looked so amazing in my hand. So large and impressive. I was filled with this feeling of overflowing. Like a canister under pressure that was ready to burst. But I didn’t know what bursting would mean. There was an abounding feeling of determination. Like I wanted this. Wanted to interact with this. I wanted to do so much with this thing in my hand. I wanted to spend all night with it. I wanted to spend all night giving pleasure to this amazing thing between Tommy’s legs. I wanted to stroke it. I wanted to do a lot more—but wouldn’t. I knew I wouldn’t. I wanted Tommy to feel pleasure—that was all. Wanted him to make him happy, wanted to make him erupt the way I’d made Charlie erupt that day. Knew that Tommy would like it and not make me feel bad for wanting to give him sexual pleasure.

So I stroked him. Stroked him with purpose. Both of us quiet and not saying anything. My hand going up and down, Tommy groaning, shifting, loving what I was doing. The more he showed me he loved it, the more I wanted to

do it. My heart was beating for him. My heart was beating with purpose, wanting a result. Wanting to finish this thing successfully. Wanted him to burst. I wanted him to growl, I wanted him to show me the proof that I did a good job for him. I thought of the way Charlie's semen had come from him in wet bursts and slick ropes that had wrapped my knuckles and splashed his shirt. Charlie was so mad about the mess on his shirt. But Tommy wouldn't be mad. There would be no feelings of regret from Tommy. Maybe me—but I was committed. I was going to make Tommy Healy come.

"Is this any good?" I kept asking as he began thrusting himself through my grip.

"Wait, wait," he said, and my heart broke. I'd done something wrong.

"No," I whined, stroking even faster, desperately wanting to see his come.

"No, don't," he said, gripping my wrist and stopping my movement.

"But . . ."

"Stop, stop . . ."

"I'm sorry," I said, my fingers coming off the great feel of his hard dick in my hand. My eyes swelled like I wanted to cry, but Tommy gathered himself, then looked at me.

"Sorry," he said, "I don't want to come. Not yet . . ."

"You don't?"

He shook his head no.

"Why don't you?"

He didn't answer with words, instead leaned a hand out behind him, his stomach muscles stretched against this tight skin, eyeing me, then his free hand coming to touch my stomach.

I jumped and jolted. “Oh no, don’t,” I whispered, and I folded my arms—but not to trap his hand or to block it, instead putting them over my breasts. And that allowed Tommy’s hand to touch my navel, his fingers going even lower. I couldn’t even fight it. My thighs parted slowly. I opened my flower to a man that wouldn’t be my husband. Tommy Healy, sexy big dick Tommy Healey. Nice guy. Good guy. Trustworthy.

It was all okay when he touched me. I cried out across the cool lake breeze. The incredible pleasure of being touched for the first time is impossible to explain. The feeling of another person finally touching the intimate space you have was bewildering and emotionally profound. He teased and stroked, slid his fingers all around in circles, dabbing up inside, rolling around my clitoris until I felt like I was going to suffocate. My breathing was erratic, and somewhere along the way I’d put my hands out behind me, feet in the sand, butt on the grassy lip, knees out wide in a vulgar display as Tommy fingered me. My breasts heaved as I panted for breath, and I felt hurdled. Thrust toward something. Then drawn. Shoved roughly from behind and pulled into an embrace. My first orgasm. I squeaked and gasped, clapped my thighs against his good-looking hand. He held it in place, gently massaging against me, being careful. My eyes fluttered. His face was close to mine. He kissed me softly, and I didn’t stop him. Instead I touched his neck, touched his chest, and then he was rolling, leaning into me, his chest against mine, getting on top of me. And I didn’t fight it, I lay back in the grass, and he got between my legs, and I lifted my knees, squeezed my thighs on his hips. He got that big weapon into place and I told him I’m a virgin.

He said, “I know you are, Cindy.”

I looked in his eyes. “Is it going to hurt?”

“I’m going to be careful,” he said.



And he was careful. He was gentle. But it hurt. It hurt like crazy. It took the longest time to get in, and at one point I was ready to give up. I told him it was too much. My neck burned, the backs of my arms went pins and needles. But when it was finally in, that tearing feeling was gone. It was replaced with overwhelming luxurious pleasure that swirled and swooshed in my belly. He thrust that huge thing in and out of me, never going too deep—not at first, not till I was ready—being careful and loving. We really did make love. I made love to Tommy Healey that evening. The two of us on the beach, plain old missionary style, my nails dragging on his back as he made love to me. He made me come again. I orgasmed and my muscles squirmed on his massive intrusion as I did. I bit his neck. That was what gave me away. The next day all anybody could talk about was where did Tommy get that mark on his neck. They all knew we'd been away all day together and didn't get back on our bikes till it was almost full dark.

When he continued after I orgasmed, I rolled through yet another one. Three came fast, each one on the other's heels. He left me shuddering, my legs shaking and trembling. It turned out I'm quite orgasmic. At least I was with Tommy.

He bewildered me with his cock. Consumed me, owned me, dominated me. For that half an hour, he was everything in my world and all I ever wanted to do forever was make love. How could this have been denied so long to me, I wondered in small slivers of clarity. We connected. Tommy and I looked in each other's eyes. We shared little laughs. We kissed while we did it. I gave Tommy my tongue.

But when Tommy's breaths came quick and hard, I warned him: "Don't come inside me." I had no need for the pill since I was celibate, and that night was not the safest time in my cycle.

Tommy pulled it out, and I immediately missed the wonderful deep stretch it'd delivered. Considered telling him to put it back in for just a few more thrusts. I felt its weight drop onto my belly. Slick, squirming, a beautiful ramrod straight snake. He jerked it, but I shoved his hand away, telling him, "I want to make you come, Tommy . . ."

And with one hand around the back of his neck, I tucked my chin down and watched as I jerked him off between our naked bodies. He came in a delicious soaking torrent. Shooting on my stomach, my breasts, and even on my face. I stroked until it tickled him, and he laughed and fell against me. Then it was done. I wasn't a virgin anymore. I cheated on my fiancé and had sex with another man. My wedding night was ruined. But I didn't feel hurt or shame. I did feel a strange emptiness—but over top of it there was a crazy jubilation. A satisfaction. The world hadn't ended. I'd had sex with Tommy Healy, and the earth still spun.

Part 3

Outro

There was so much more I wanted to know. I order more coffee, remind her it's on me. Do you want a sandwich? She doesn't. Pastry? She's watching her figure. I asked her why she doesn't wear a wedding ring.

She tells me she's divorced for five years now. I asked her the most important question. One I'd waited to ask when I met her in person. Did you marry Charlie?

She nods. I don't like the wet gleam in her eyes. It was like the letter she wrote me contained only the parts that were good. Now that we meet in person, she was going to have to tell me the bad.

She said, "I married Charlie on schedule. Two years later."

"And what about Tommy? Did you ever see him again?"

She chuckles, and instantly she's brighter. "Oh yes," she said. "It wasn't just that one time."

Now I brighten. "Is that true?"

"I felt like my letter had gone on long enough. I spent a lot of time writing that to you, and when I got to the end of that first experience, I felt satisfied. I was worried that you would never read it anyway."

I told her I read it and loved it.

"I know you do now. But when I wrote it, I felt like that was a fine ending point."

I'm bubbling, practically squealing on the inside. "So you saw more of Tommy?"

“Yes. I did.”

“How many more times?”

“Well, we never had sex again. Not that summer. Some of the other girl counselors were on to me. They pushed and pushed, but Tommy and I had our story ready. We hung out at the bridge, some college kids came and were swimming. Tommy made out with one of those girls.”

“You’re crafty.”

“I definitely didn’t want to get caught.”

“Tell me more.”

“The rest of that summer, we just explored.” Now she looks around nervously; writing down these lustful thoughts were one thing, uttering them were another thing altogether. I remind her of my infamous candor. I tell her she’s safe with me.

She wants to tell me. I can see it. She nods, continues. “He taught me how to . . . give head. In the old vernacular, I suppose. Do people still say that?”

I nod.

“He taught me. Out in the canoe, the two of us would go out at dusk, paddle out onto Lake Wennebisko, and he’d take his shorts off. He showed me what felt good, showed me how to do it.” She smirks. “Taught me to swallow.” She winces at the sound of her own words. But I laugh at her reaction, and she laughs too.

“And then?”

“That was it. I used my mouth on him. And . . .”

“Oh yeah?” I’m hopeful . . .

She nods again, smiling. “Yes. We took turns. Sometimes we would even do it simultaneously.”

“Sixty-nine? In a canoe?”

She rolls her eyes up to look at the rafter ceiling of this fancy coffee shop with its original art for sale on the walls. Her smile’s unstoppable. “Sixty-nine. Yes. We did that a lot. In a canoe.”

“Whatever happened to you and Tommy?”

“I told myself what I had with Tommy was just about sex. The next school year we exchanged letters a few times, but neither of us committed anything to paper saying how we missed each other. I was so afraid to make it real in writing, and so afraid that if I did, Tommy would make it real in return. I didn’t know how I could deal with intimate thoughts coming from him. But I missed him. Mostly I feared our letters being discovered by Charlie.”

“Charlie didn’t know at all?”

She shook her head no slowly. “He didn’t. The next summer we were at Great Woods again. Tommy and I couldn’t keep our hands off each other. All summer long. We’d go out to the dam and go skinny dipping. We’d have sex. We lit fires on the beach. I loved using my hand on him. We kissed. But we never talked about ourselves as a couple. It was just sex. At least that’s what I told myself.”

“It was more than sex?”

“The next school year, Tommy visited me. Charlie never did. It was four-and-a-half hours from Charlie’s school to mine and I barely saw him. It was a five hour bus ride for Tommy. I saw him every weekend. Sometimes I would make it easier on him, bus out and we would meet halfway. We would go to this Motel 6, go out to see movies, then back to our hotel room and make love all night long.”

“And you still married Charlie?”

She shrugged and her eyes glistened again. “I never questioned that I wouldn’t. I always knew I would. I hope you don’t think that I didn’t love Charlie.”

“You must have.”

“Charlie was amazing. I didn’t put it in my letter, but I really love that man.”

Now I worry about her absent wedding ring.

She said, “Tommy and I got together one last time, a month before my wedding. Both of us knew it was going to be the last time. That Monday morning before he got on the bus both of us broke down and cried. We held each other. But neither one of us said What if you don’t marry Charlie? And that’s what I did.”

“And you never saw Tommy again?”

“No. Well I saw him. We never had sex again. Ever. Not after I was married.”

We break off from talk of Tommy and Charlie for a moment. And she tells me about her daughters. Both of them had been counselors at Great Woods. I don’t ask if she thinks they ever had experiences like her there, but I know she’s thinking about it. We order some sparkling water. She would like an apple.

She said, “I married Charlie, and I never looked back.”

There’s something important I want to ask, but I don’t want to offend her. It’s for the purpose of the book, and I begin forming questions but stop. She waits patiently, then deciphers what my question would have been. She said, “No. It was never the same.”

“Sex?” I ask.

“I never had sex with Charlie like I had with Tommy.”

“Isn’t that . . . Does that upset you?”

“I love Charlie. Charlie gave me two amazing daughters. We raised great girls, we were a great family.”

“What happened?”

“Once the girls were grown up, Charlie and I were like two acquaintances living in the same house. Without the purpose of the family, it was like we were just sharing an apartment. We divorced five years ago.”

“And you’re okay with that?”

“That I divorced him? Yes. I’m still here in Steamboat, I have a nice apartment. Charlie’s moved on though, gone to Arizona. The girls spend time with him too.”

“Whatever happened with Tommy? You said you saw him again?”

She said, “When Facebook came around, I looked him up.”

“You were still married to Charlie at the time?”

“I was. I looked him up and he wasn’t there. I checked again maybe a year later, and I found him. God he was old. As old as I was.”

“Did you contact him?”

She shook her head no and I was disappointed.

She said, “He contacted me. I don’t know, it must’ve been around 2010. His relationship status said he was married. He had three boys. Asked me how I was doing, and I told him. At the time, the girls just started college. They were the same age as his boys. His wife had cancer. A year later she was gone and he was a widower.”

“Oh.”

“A few years after that, one of his sons was killed by a drunk driver. I told Charlie I was going birdwatching out in Oregon, but I went to the funeral. I didn’t talk to Tommy. Didn’t even meet him. But I sat in the parking lot and saw him out front of the funeral home.”

My stomach twists, and I grimace. “That must’ve been so hard.”

“I can’t even believe I did it. I can’t believe after all those years I would have so much emotion for him. He was the only reason I even took up birdwatching.”

“He’s a birdwatcher?”

“It was on his Facebook. And I love the outdoors, I love nature, and I was in my early fifties. I bought some binoculars . . .”

“And you never . . .?”

“Talked to Tommy? Yes. Once I was divorced, I talked to him. I talked to him a lot.” Now she fidgets. I can sense that she’s biting the lining of her cheek.

I get goosebumps. “You’re going to meet him.”

“In the summer. We’re going to go to Mexico.”

“Birdwatching?”

She nods. The book she has on the table is a guidebook for songbirds of the South American region. She looked at the book and smiled. “I brought it in in case you were late.”

“I wouldn’t have missed this story for the world,” I tell her.

In the fall, I got a phone call from Cindy. I'd given her my phone number. I'd sent her emails, too, letting her know how my book was going. She's very kind. When I saw her name on my screen, I snatched up my phone.

It was good news. They'd gone to Mexico together. She told me about the birds they'd seen. I didn't care about birds. Like a teeny-bopper Great Woods camp counselor, I whispered into my phone: "Did you kiss him?"

She laughed. She said, "I don't kiss and tell. But I will say there's a lot of promise . . ."

Another phone call. Christmas. Cindy tells me that she's going on a cruise.

"Oh?" I say. "Wow, we're just friends now, you're calling up to let me know your travel plans." But I know there's more to say. She says it.

"Tommy and I. Four week cruise around Alaska. One cabin."

"You dog," I say.

I got a phone call from Cindy the other day. She had bad news. My heart sunk.

She said, “As much as I’d like to invite you to the wedding, I’m afraid I just can’t.”

I burst out laughing and tell her how she’d just given me a heart attack. She says she’d practiced her opening line for maximum effect.

When I ask her where the wedding is, she tells me it’s in Sarasota. I said, “Oh, where Tommy lives.”

She says, “Where I live.” This broad had moved to be near Tommy six months ago. Talk about thirsty. When I call her thirsty, she scolds me. I assure her she’s my hero.

“I hope you know I would love to have you there at the wedding. I owe so much to you.” She is earnest, and I can hear how it pains her.

I tell her I understand. And I do. But, God, would I ever love to be there. I vow to myself to be in Sarasota that weekend, sitting in my car across the street with binoculars. I will not be watching birds.

Cindy said, “My daughters would know who you are, and I can’t for the life of me figure out an explanation for how we’d know each other.”

It was true. I said, “You’re right—they’ll realize their mom wasn’t a virgin when she married their dad, and her good friend Tommy from camp must have a big old elephant trunk in his pants.”

“You dog,” she said.

Epilogue

So there you have it: my three favorite tales related to me by the multitude of women I've met over the last six months. There were more, but these were really the standouts. Each of the women risked a lot. Their experiences weren't easy. Were there choices immoral? Probably, yes. I know, some you are screaming right now: Yes! Yes! Yes!

All right. Yes. Immoral. But that's why I asked the question I asked. What was it about a man that had you willing to risk much that you'd earned? Now, for this to be truly scientific, I know I would also have to interview women who risked it all for men with normal-sized penises. Boring. Besides, my thesis relates to one thing: size. I think there was something about Kristy, that tricky Kristy, that got close. The way she submitted to Ryan. The way she worshiped his extra-large penis. . . . That's the best representation. Right there. Good luck to me, trying to figure it out. The woman known as Kristy is now gone. No emails returned, she's disappeared in the wind. When I called the hotel, I discovered the information she'd given to them was inaccurate. I used her fake name here, but even what I presume to be her real name was also a fake name. If she's reading this, we are not done. I'm not mad at you, in fact I'm inspired. I want to know more. Call me.

I'm no closer to figuring it all out, and I suppose I never will be. There's a certain subset of us who suffer from this, and though it's a big number, it is not the norm. But I've presented three women with solid cases. Three women who were curious to discover what it would really be like. And they found out. And yes, they were curious because something in them told them it would be better. And when they partook?—It was better. How did they know that? All three women had no prior experience. They'd perhaps tittered amongst friends about boys, but none of them knew for sure. What made them curious in the first place? Is it puritanical? The fact that what exists between a man's leg is hidden from us day-to-day inspire the

curiosity? Heck, maybe my dumb old premise for VPL's when I was writing at Teen Vixen were correct. Maybe if we were exposed to bulges all day long, the big bulges would cease to be so attractive. Maybe after a while it might become repulsive. I need to endeavor an exploration of this. I read somewhere, and it's not verified, that there was a time in the Greek empire when smaller penises were considered more aesthetic. How the heck did that happen? My modern liberated woman's brain says that it's bullshit, but I can't rule that out. I might need to spend some time talking to historians. Thank God I love what I do!

While I'm no closer to tracking down the answers I seek, I will keep looking. If more stories like the ones I related here come across my email, I might just write them down. Be sure to let me know what you think!—(and if you know someone who's had the same experience, send them my way, I'm always ready to hear a good story . . .)

Afterword

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